

Part 5: Monster Customization

At the heart of Mortasheen are its **monsters**: Unnatural non-meta-human creatures that sometimes arise through design, sometimes through the evolution of other monsters, sometimes through industrial accidents, and occasionally through processes no one has yet intuited. As a mad scientist, monsters are your bread and butter as well as your jam, so you'll spend a lot of time during your adventures coordinating, recruiting, and creating your own.

The following system is intended to give you an enormous amount of flexibility in customizing your monsters, whether you're tweaking one you've picked up somewhere or starting from scratch. Monsters are made from **parts**, and those parts house the monster's **abilities**, which are in turn made from **blocks** you select by spending points. You can only use blocks you've learned how to create, but you can combine them to make almost any ability you can imagine. Monster abilities can manifest however you like: You get to decide what they look like when you build them.

Reminder:

You generally roll +GENIUS! when contributing to projects, like altering a monster or creating a monster from scratch.

Acquiring Monsters

No mad scientist just pops into existence fully formed, with a whole team of elite monsters by their side (unless you create an advanced character, which is always an option). Usually, your first monster is your initial YGORE, which you either develop during your education or receive from someone as a graduation gift. That monster will become a lifelong companion for many, but it's rarely the **only** monster a mad scientist will ever have by their side. **During your adventures, you'll begin with a "starter" monster as your YGORE, then pad out your own team through capture, familiarization, trade, or manufacture.**

YGORES

There will always be that one monster who's a little more special to you than the others—kind of like that friend you call your **best** friend and really mean it (as opposed to the people you **call** your best friend but to whom you hesitate to loan large amounts of money, and you **definitely** pretend you're asleep and don't see the notification when they need help changing a tire or something at unwholesome hours).

For a mad scientist, that special monster is their **YGORE**. Pronounced "**EE**-gor" (or occasionally "**EYE**-gor," in certain regions), the acronym stands for "Your Go-To Option Regarding Endeavors," representing that this particular monster is your first solution to most problems. What you define as a "problem" may vary depending on the type of character you're playing, so your YGORE may be an unstoppable killing machine, a helpful lab assistant, or even just a cute little thing, oh my goodness **look** at it, it's so adorable **yes it is**.

When you begin your career as a mad scientist, your YGORE will probably be chosen from the standard list of the **Demishade class**, so it won't be anything unique—except to you. You may keep it by your side for your entire career, improving and altering it until it's either a supercharged version of its original form or has become an altogether different monster species, entirely. Conversely, you may discard it (like the callous, uncaring villain you are) in favor of a cooler monster, or simply decide not to revive it when it's been squashed, blown up, or eviscerated. Your group might also elect to begin their careers with different monsters of similar overall point values.

If you do choose to start with different monsters of equal power, note that the Demishades are specifically designed to help you get a jump-start on researching and customizing, so the choice to use a custom monster now may result in you waiting longer to build and customize further once you begin.

No matter the case, **you can only designate one monster as your YGORE at any given time, and can only redesignate your YGORE as a downtime action** (unless you're a manager), and you can't share an YGORE with another mad scientist. Whichever monster is your YGORE gains a few benefits for as long as it holds the title:

- **Your YGORE is always loyal.** Even if its Brains attribute exceeds your MADNESS! score, your YGORE never becomes disobedient, and you never have to make a DISCOURSE! roll to control it.
- **Your YGORE won't take actions to harm you under any circumstances.** This includes when they're affected by conditions such as haywire or amok, or even under the influence of mind control! (Although they may still harm other allies)
- **Your YGORE can intercept attacks meant for its scientist within close by range.**
- **Your YGORE is easier to change, improve or recreate.** You know your YGORE like the back of your hand—it's your most familiar monster, and that familiarity is inside and out. Taking parts off it, sticking them on, or tinkering with its abilities takes less time, effort, and materials for you, and doing so costs half the usual cost in data AND has half the typical project goal.

Reminder:

You roll +DISCOURSE! versus a monster's +Brains to command it if it disobeys you. Monsters may become disobedient if their Brains attribute is greater than your MADNESS! score.

Scanalysis

To recreate a monster, you must first scanalyze it.

Scanalysis is a major action any mad scientist can perform (actions are covered in part 5). You're always assumed to have the necessary equipment to perform scanalysis unless your PC finds themselves in a situation where that capability has been explicitly removed, such as having their gear taken. The process is like the projects described in part 3: You need to reach a specific scanalysis goal to achieve a full scanalysis of a monster.

You roll +SCIENCE! and apply the total result directly toward your goal, so a result of 10 means 10 points toward completion of the current scanalysis. This often takes multiple actions, and is often performed under stress since you can't scanalyze a dead monster—its anatomy is there, but its mind isn't. Scanalysis progress made against distinct identical instances of the same monster is all completion for that monster; in other words, as long as they're exactly the same, rolling a 3 to scanalyze a Chainsaw Kid and then rolling 9 to do so when you encounter another means you've made 12 progress toward scanalyzing Chainsaw Kid, as long as they all have the same set of blocks. Members of the same think tank are assumed to share scanalysis data (unless they make it clear they aren't doing that, for some reason), so just like with a project, every PC's scanalysis of a given monster contributes toward complete scanalysis for the whole group.

Reminder:

You roll +SCIENCE! when scanalyzing monsters to learn their properties.

Scanalyzing is critical to understanding how a monster works; it tells you all the important stuff about the subject, such as its component parts, the abilities assigned to each of those parts, its class and core feature, its attributes, and its temperament—**none of which you know until you scanalyze it!** These aren't just useful because they tell you what to expect from the monster, but because you need to know whether capture is viable.

Determining scanalysis goals is easy- **add the monster's Brains and Brawn together, and then apply a multiplier based on its monster class.** Times two for most monsters, times three for Postgrad monsters, and times four for Esoterrors.

So for example, let's look at the Chainsaw Kid from before. It has 6 Brains and 6 Brawn, and it's a Bioconstruct- not a Postgrad or Esoterrifying monster class. Thusly, the scanalysis goal for a normal Chainsaw Kid is 24. Halfway there!

Familiarizing Monsters

If a monster is willing to consider joining you, **you start a project to build trust**, work out contracts and agreements, show them around the lair, let them sniff your other monsters through the bathroom door, and otherwise get properly acquainted. **Unlike most projects, this research is a +DISCOURSE! roll, since you're talking it out.**

Once the project is complete, you've convinced the monster you're friendly, whether that's by stimulating conversation or throwing enough dog treats at it to choke a wormtrain. Thenceforth, as long as you treat it well, it'll follow your reasonable orders, or at least hang around and help you out when you need it. And since you'll need it to make any adjustments, **a monster you've familiarized will submit to a full scanalysis that you can complete with one downtime action.** Speaking of, you determine the project goal for familiarizing very similarly to how you determine scanalysis goals. Add the monster's Brains and Brawn together, and then its Brains again. Then apply the same monster class modifiers you do for scanalysis and other projects.

[(Brains x 2)+[Brawn]]x[Class Modifier] = Familiarization Project Goal

Of course, if a monster CAN'T simply be convinced to join you- if it's a wild animal, or otherwise something you can make a case for kind of ethical capture of -you have to actually get it back to your lair. This'll probably involve restraints of some sort, but you could just kill it and bring the body back to your lab. But try not to make too much work for yourself- if it's dead on arrival, you'll have to fire up the cloning pods and wait til the downtime after that for it to respawn. And if you relax your gaurd too much, you might just get roped into another combat if the monster wakes up on the wrong side of the bed.

Hypothetically, you could bring a dead monster that's smart enough to demand payment back to your lair to revive it, and then talk to it, but it's a risky move. A monster that wakes up in someone else's house could have any variety of reactions. They might be grateful for a second chance at life, they might immediately assume nefarious intent, or they might even be resentful of you for bringing them back after achieving the peace of final rest.

Trading Monsters

Other mad scientists are often reasonable people, and they can be convinced to barter if you've got something they want. It's uncommon, but **as a project, you can exchange one of your monsters for a monster commanded by another mad scientist.** The project represents appropriate negotiations, including getting the consent of any smart enough monsters, **so it's a DISCOURSE! project.** Most folks aren't interested in swapping for something of lesser value, so they'll usually only agree to trade their monster for one whose total data cost equals or exceeds that monster's.

At the Proctor's option, you might be able to talk someone into swapping a monster they ordinarily wouldn't by successfully engaging them in spirited debate. A mad scientist might also be more flexible on a trade if your monster includes something they want, like an ability block they don't already have.

Manufacturing Monsters

The most time-consuming (but also the most rewarding) method of getting a new monster is by growing it yourself. You'll have to design the monster using known blocks to create abilities, which you'll install into a number of body parts that can't exceed your total parts limit. Then you'll pay a data cost to purchase raw biomaterials, and finally perform a project to actually generate the monster from your Biovat. Of course you have a Biovat! Who builds a home without one?!

When the project reaches completion, you pop your new friend out of the tank, ready to join your adventures! These same steps can also be used to make adjustments to an existing monster, or directly replicate a monster you've fully scanalyzed.

Reminder: You can actively command a number of monsters equal to your DISCOURSE! score. Monsters you're actively commanding are those physically traveling with you or on call via telepopper as part of your team. Monsters you've created or who are otherwise loyal to you, but which aren't part of your active team don't count.

When building a monster from scratch, you'll follow these steps:

- Designate the **project lead** for the monster, if more than one mad scientist is contributing to the process. That PC is the one whose discoveries and similar abilities affect the monster's final attributes and so on, for the purpose of adjudicating language such as "when you create or alter a monster."
- Determine the monster's **class** by choosing an associated core.
- Check the **maximum number of parts** your monsters can have. This starts out equal to your SCIENCE! score, but don't forget to check abilities like the surgeon's core feature when adding this up!
- Choose your monster's **size**.
- Figure out the points you can divide between the monster's **Brains and Brawn** attributes by adding your SCIENCE! and MADNESS! scores together. This also creates the pool you'll spend from to build abilities using blocks.
- Once you've assigned Brains and Brawn, use the blocks you know to **design abilities** and install them in the monster's parts.
- Assign **endurance** boxes to the monster's parts. Usually you've got a pool of boxes equal to (10 + your respectability), but special abilities may change that number.
- Determine the **total data cost and project goal** of the monster based on its endurance, ability points and class, then pay that cost to begin a project. When you finish the project...

IT'S ALIIIVE!!

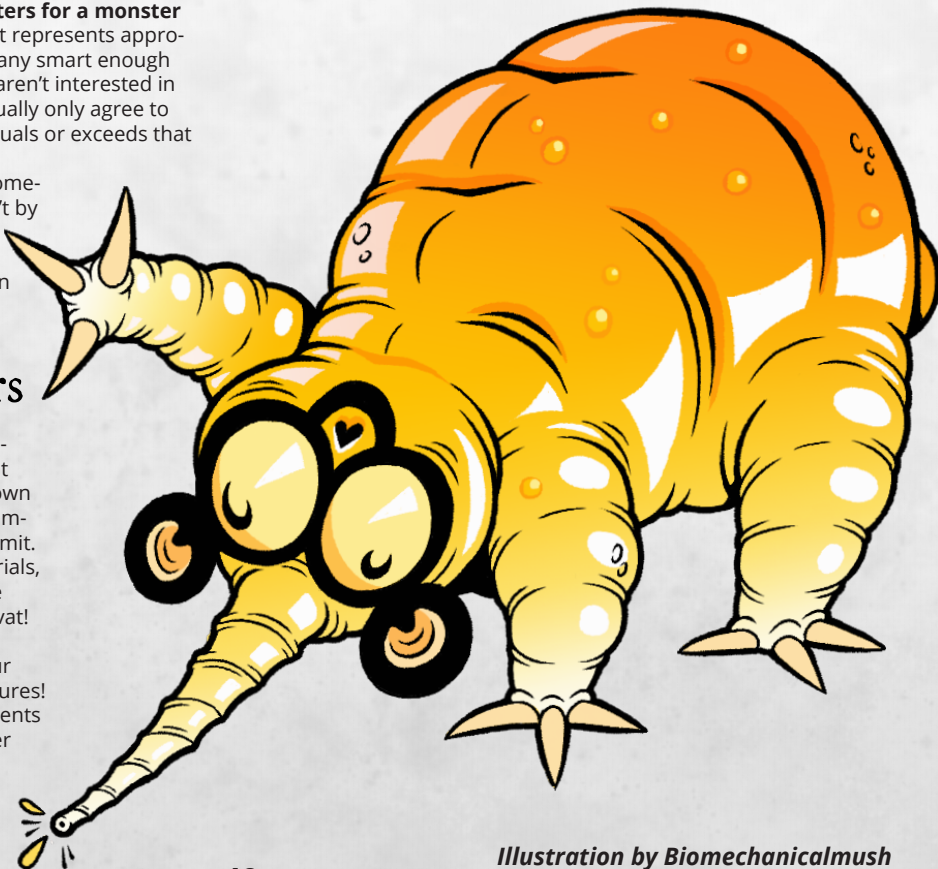


Illustration by Biomechanicalmush

Monster Classes

Every monster falls into one of several possible categories, which determine its basic nature. Monsters within a given **class** may vary widely in temperament, size, abilities, and appearance, but they all share some intrinsic property housed in their **core**—the central mechanism of a monster to which all its other parts are attached—and is appropriately called the class's **core feature**, just like a player's discipline or think tank.

Cores are critical to monster construction and identity: they house the stored consciousness and personality of a monster, as well as its memories. **A core is a body part for purposes of adjudicating how and when it's affected by attacks and so forth, but it doesn't count against your total limit for body parts per monster.** However, you can't add additional abilities to it, nor can you assign additional endurance boxes—a **core always has just 1 endurance box, and if it breaks, the monster dies**, no matter how many of its other parts remain intact.

Some monsters are part of an **advanced class**, one that is either only for Postgrads or even a nightmarish **ESOTERROR** meant only for experts. **A mad scientist can only create, alter, or even ally with such monsters if they have enough respectability.** You can recruit **Postgrad** monsters when your respectability hits 5, and **Esoterrors** when your respectability hits 10, but there are discoveries to let you grab each class up to 5 levels earlier.

When you *don't* have the proper experience but you've still got advanced-class monsters, your reputation will take a major hit with most people: -2 for Postgrad monsters and a whopping -10 for Esoterrors.

The known classes are summarized below, but each is detailed much more thoroughly in the Monsters chapter.



Bioconstructs

Bioconstructs are the most common class of monster by number of species. They're "normal" monsters, sometimes fully organic, sometimes partly inorganic, and all are self-replicating to some degree. They comprise the vast majority of created monster species within Mortasheen and beyond its considerable borders.

Bioconstruct Core Feature: Splice of Life

When you create a Bioconstruct, or alter one you created, **assign it a single quirk.** This quirk functions exactly the same as those of a mad scientist, as described in part 1: The monster may invoke its quirk once per adventure to automatically succeed on a challenge or task relevant to the quirk, and may voluntarily take its lowest result on any die roll to refresh the quirk.

If you familiarize a Bioconstruct, you cannot change its quirk, because that quirk represents the monster's personal history, and you might even encounter Bioconstructs whose quirks don't match up with the default one in the bestiary entries.

Because they have only one, the Proctor can't invoke a Bioconstruct's quirk in order to add a complication to a scene- but they might take inspiration from it if the monster is disobedient.

BIOCONSTRUCT SUBCLASS: VAMPIRE THRALL

Some Bioconstructs were created as thralls by mighty Vampires to serve their needs, combining aspects of retrohumans, sea life, and sometimes bats to make amphibious minions. *Vampire Thrall* Bioconstructs have their own alternate core feature:

Vampire Thrall Core Feature: Thicker Than Water

When you create or alter a Vampire Thrall Bioconstruct, assign it a single quirk. This quirk functions the same as for a mad scientist or other Bioconstruct, except that the monster may only invoke its quirk as a reaction to allow the success of a challenge or task by its scientist, an allied Vampire, or another authority figure it recognizes. Typically, this does not include other members of your think tank.



Arthropoids

Arthropoids are a class of adaptable "bug-type" monsters. Beloved by Sectilians, they combine the specialization of insects, arachnids, and similar creatures with the intelligence and scale of a Metahuman. Arthropoids reproduce quickly and effectively, making them the most common monster class by population.

Arthropoid Core Feature: Chitter Chatter

An Arthropoid will only disobey if you have seriously hurt it (at which point it may attack you!), it can always express itself clearly, and it can always participate in a spirited debate by rolling two dice plus half its Brains. The Arthropoid has a special endurance track of five boxes that it only uses for spirited debate, which cannot otherwise be targeted and does not count as a part in any way. It takes roll penalties in a spirited debate as normal for marked stress. If its

special endurance track is fully marked, it cannot participate in a spirited debate, but it suffers no penalties in a heated exchange. This track is fully healed during a rest.

This is the normal amount of Brains monsters use in debates- more on that later. An Arthropoid effectively has [EXPRESS +0d10] as a feature.

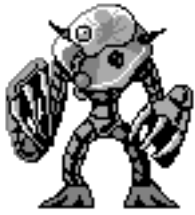


Biogarbage

Biogarbage monsters are spontaneous mutations. They arise as leftovers of monster generation and the runoff of Mortasheen's innumerable laboratory experiments. Despite their sometimes pitiable nature, however, they're still monsters and therefore subjects of frequent interest—and everyone has potential, especially in Mortasheen.

Biogarbage Core Feature: Another Meta's Treasure

Biogarbage monsters can and must have weakness(es) equal to their total ability point allowance, which grants them that many bonus points as normal, defined as you choose across as many discrete weaknesses as you like.



Biomecha

Biomecha are a class of cyborg monsters powered by brains. Favored by physicists, their organic bodies are cybernetically enhanced, combining chitin and cartilage with machinery and computers. Most are special-purpose, designed to assist mad scientists with particular types of tasks at home and abroad.

Biomech Core Feature: Plug and Play

When you create a Biomech, you also create a brain for it. This brain is a gadget that may only consist of a single part, and must have an ability that makes sense for a brain, like a psychic power or a behavioral directive, but it otherwise follows all the typical rules for gadgets, like endurance and ability points based on your GENIUS! score.

The brain does not count as a body part when determining whether the monster's core is exposed, or whether it's destroyed rather than dead. Using it is still generally a major action, as appropriate for the installed ability, and only the Biomech can control the brain.

You can make more brains the same way as you can other gadgets, and if you do, you may use a downtime action to swap the brain out of a biomech for another one. If the brain you want is in another Biomech already, you may switch the two brains as a single action. If the Biomech's class is changed temporarily in some way, the Brain remains safely inside but the Biomech loses access to the ability stored within and it does not benefit from it as a part



Boo Men

The Boo Men are a group of legendary Esoterrors of unknown origins, blurring the boundaries between Monster and Metahuman. Each is closer to a single, unique being than a species, but can spread its mind across multiple instances of itself. For unclear reasons, all Boo Men operate as mercenaries for hire.

You can't create Boo Men, but you can alter one that you hire, if you have the chops for it. The Boo Men won't complain about working with someone below respectability 10 if your data's good, but it may lead to severe repercussions with other metas and monsters. The project to familiarize a Boo Man always includes an extravagant-level data expense. More often, you can hire a Boo Man temporarily for a smaller fee.

Boo Man Core Feature: Made Myself For This

Each Boo Man has an Obsession, an academic or artistic pursuit that can be studied. When engaging in that obsession, the Boo Man's dice explode on a result of 9 as well as on a result of 10, and it treats all rolls of 1 on its dice as a result of 2.



Botanicals

Botanicals are a class of vegetal hybrid monsters. They're all complex creatures that are part animal and part plant. You can develop Botanicals by fertilizing retrofloral ("normal") plants with Green Goo, so they can largely be trusted to grow themselves without much scientist involvement.

Botanical Core Feature: Grass is Greener

Botanical monsters readily accept tissue grafts from even very alien sources, so a Botanical doesn't need a project to edit it. Just pay the data cost and one downtime action and let the monster do the rest!

You may also forego other benefits of a rest to edit a Botanical monster during an adventure, if you have monster parts on hand.



Demishades

Demishades are a class of monsters similar to the metahuman biotype known as Shades They're a scientist's best friend, as enthusiastic about learning and research as you are, and hide themselves under clothlike skins that mirror various other monster types.

Demishade Core Feature: Watch the World Learn

When you create a Demishade, or alter one you created, choose an Affinity for it, which represents a certain type of lifeform such as a monster class that is driven to learn about. It gains a Crystoform part with 2 points to be spent on either [CORRAL] or [CULL], using its affinity as the descriptor. This part and these points are in addition to parts and

points from your SCIENCE! and MADNESS!.

If you familiarize a Demishade, you cannot change its affinity or swap its [CULL] or [CORRAL], because that affinity has been reinforced by decades of the monster's personal history.

Additionally, instead of just adding its Brains to a research project when it is left at the lair, a Demishade will contribute an extra research roll (+Brains) to a project, even if it was taken with you on your adventure. It adds two extra dice to this roll if it somehow involves the Demishade's affinity.

A Demishade can't contribute to research immediately after it is born on the same downtime.



Devilbirds

Devilbirds are an Esoterror-grade class of psychological bioweapons. Only their long-vanished creators could clarify their true intentions, but the sinister creatures live as mental parasites that encourage various behavior patterns to self-destructive excess.

You can't create or alter Devilbirds unless you're at respectability 10, and even having them on your team or hanging around your lair can lead to severe repercussions, if you're not.

Most Devilbirds have their own unique core feature that cannot be replicated, and you will need to obtain an unaltered feral specimen if you want a Devilbird with its signature feature. When you scanalyze a Devilbird, you only learn the following core feature, applied to any cloned or created Devilbird monster:

Devilbird Replicant Core Feature: DESPERATIO

If a Devilbird replicant is physically with you when you make a dice roll with any non-Devilbird character, it may invoke its power as a reaction to replace a single die result of your choice with a 10. You must decide whether to use this feature after the roll is made and before it's resolved. The replacement 10 explodes as though it were a natural result.

Whenever you use this feature, record a tally mark on your mad scientist's character sheet. For each tally mark you have, you must spend 1 downtime action to indulge in some form of maladaptive, self-destructive behaviour, often doomsday prophesying. When you do so, clear a tally mark. As long as you have tally marks remaining as a result of this feature, you can't spend downtime actions to do anything else. Tally marks from multiple Devilbirds all go into the same counter.



Ectophasms

Ectophasms are a Postgrad class of semi-corporeal monsters. Usually found hibernating in crystalline cysts deep within the planet's crust, their origins are myserious and their countenances ghostly and primitive. Most Ectophasms have predictable behavioral patterns that determine the places and creatures they "haunt."

You can't create or alter Ectophasms unless you're at respectability 5, and even having them on your team or hanging around your lair can lead to some repercussions, if you're not.

Ectophasm Core Feature: Free Spirit

Solid objects aren't an issue for Ectophasms; they can "phase" through obstacles like walls, doors, floors, ceilings, and even creatures unless some effect prevents them from doing so. Antipsigital barriers like scramblefields, for instance, tend to block phasing. Since they can phase, Ectophasms can generally occupy the same space as another creature or object, regardless of size, can't be held down, and they can swim or "burrow" at their land speed by default. Each obstacle an Ectophasm phases through deals it 1 stress as it leaves some of its mass behind. This ability does not allow an Ectophasm to target parts that are hidden by some effect such as [INSULATE] or to attack straight for the core.



Fectoids

Fectoids are a Postgrad class of infectious monsters made from fungal and bacterial matter. They're like advanced diseases, able to dissolve into a microbial swarm or reconstitute into a solid body. Typical Fectoid species or "strains" are identified primarily by the conditions they cause to propagate themselves.

Fectoids have the most complex core feature, so it might be good to get used to the game before toying with them too much. But hey, if you wanna dive in, dive in! **You can't create or alter Fectoids unless you're at respectability 5, and even having them on your team or hanging around your lair can lead to some repercussions, if you're not.**

Fectoid Core Feature: Sickly Countenance

When you create or alter a Fectoid, split its points as you choose between its **macroform** body and an **infection phase**. The macroform functions as a normal monster, but the infection phase has special rules:

The infection phase does not have parts, only symptoms, but your limit on symptoms is equal to your limit on parts, including any relevant discoveries. You may create the Fectoid's symptoms using the [BOLSTER], [CURE], [FORBID], [HINDER], [INFLICT], or [REPAIR] blocks, or any ability that uses the [HIJACK] block.

- When you create or alter a Fectoid, assign one of its symptoms to be the **Onset**. The Onset cannot use the [HIJACK] block.
- **As a major action, a Fectoid in its macroform** may make an attack using its Onset, and if successful, it also transforms into its infection phase.
- During its infection phase, the Fectoid is treated as an invader (per the [INVADE] block), affecting the victim with its Onset symptom at the end of every turn.
- Since the Fectoid does not have parts in its infection phase, all stress it receives is transferred to the macroform, evenly distributed among all unbroken parts. This includes the core if it is exposed.
- The Fectoid cannot be targeted with the [PENETRATE] block, but it has a special interaction with the [CURE] block as detailed in that block's description.
- The Fectoid may use a major action to use a symptom, targeting its host.
- The Fectoid may use a major action to use its Onset against a target within engagement range of its current host, and invade that target as normal, abandoning its current host.

All conditions caused by the Fectoid end immediately if it leaves its host, its host dies, or the Fectoid is destroyed



Jokers

Jokers are an Esoterror-grade class of monsters whose consciousness resides in their internal gasses. Defined by their rubbery, elastic bodies, their love for chaos and their chemical volatility, Jokers range from mischievous to malicious in their pursuit of never-ending fun.

You can't create or alter Jokers unless you're at respectability 10, and even having them on your team or hanging around your lair can lead to severe repercussions, if you're not.

Joker Core Feature: Air Aberrant

Once per round, when a Joker's roll is being compared to another creature's, you may swap a single die of your choice from the Joker's dice pool for any die from the opposing dice pool. This decision must be made before the roll is resolved.

JOKER SUBCLASS: GLUCOID

Some Jokers, the Glucoids, are oozing candy-like lifeforms, having evolved away from a vaporous nervous system in favor of a denser, jellylike slime packed with energizing sugars.

Glucoid Joker Core Feature: Sugar Baddie

Once per round, when a monster within a range of 1 is being targeted with any effect, you may change the target of that effect to this monster. This core feature can change how a monster moves during its turn if necessary. This decision must be made before any relevant roll is resolved.



Vampires

Vampires are a Postgrad class of monsters that subsist on blood. Born from an ancient deep-ocean virus, they're nearly always derived from aquatic life and most of them have a very high Brains score, so they'll only work well with mad scientists who have high MADNESS!

You can't create Vampires at all, so you must familiarize them, and research projects to alter them use +DISCOURSE!; you first have to convince the haughty creatures that your adjustments are better than they already are. You can't hire or alter Vampires unless you're at respectability 5, and even having them on your team or hanging around your lair can lead to some repercussions, if you're not.

Vampire Core Feature: Out for Blood

Whenever another creature within a range of 1 marks stress, a Vampire clears half that amount of stress (rounded down, minimum 1) as they telekinetically draw blood toward themselves from open wounds and similar. This effect applies when the Vampire inflicts stress, and stacks with any recovery from abilities such as the [DRAIN] block.

VAMPIRE SUBCLASS: DESICCATOR

Some Vampires are dried-out, living husks residing in the many blasted deserts of the world, and weaponize water to rid themselves of excess moisture. These Vampire Desiccators have the following core feature:

Desiccator Vampire Core Feature: Suck Em Dry

Once per round when another creature within a range of 1 marks stress, you may declare that its next defense roll is penalized by half that amount (rounded down, minimum 1) as the Vampire draws the very moisture from their bodies. This effect can apply when the Vampire inflicts stress, and stacks with other defense penalties the target may have.



Warped

The Warped are an Esoterror-grade class of totally alien monsters. They're beings transformed by the after-effects of instantaneous travel across vast distances of space-time, permanently caught between otherworldly quantum systems. They interact with the physics of our universe in unpredictable ways.

You can't "create" or alter Warped unless you're at respectability 10, otherwise, toying with such otherworldly forces can lead to severe repercussions.

Warped Core Feature: Outside Perspective

A Warped treats the resistances and weaknesses of other creatures as reversed. As long as the Warped is the one attacking, the effects of [RESIST], [ARMOR], [ABSORB] and many other effects are reversed, and the effects of [SHIELD] and [INSULATE] are swapped. Don't worry, there's reminders on each block description.



Wormbrains

Wormbrains are a class of monsters made to host a parasitic hive mind. Not really conscious by themselves, per se, they're more like living vehicles for the brainflukes that drive them. Some Wormbrains incorporate more than two distinct host organisms, forming mobile, symbiotic colonies.

Wormbrain Core Feature: Scatteredbrain

Once per round a Wormbrain may clear mental conditions currently affecting it by marking 1 stress per condition it wishes to clear. It may do so even if it currently has a condition such as amok or suffers from similar effects that impede its ability to think or take actions normally.

All stress marked to clear conditions in this way must be marked at the same time (distributed however the Wormbrain wishes among its parts), and all conditions cleared in this way are cleared immediately, at the same time.

Remember, effects like [FORBID] and [HINDER] are considered conditions, too!

WORMBRAIN SUBCLASS: STINKFISH

The most extreme Wormbrains are controlled by unicellular, slime-like brainflukes from the deep ocean, their minds even more alien and nonsensical. Their vessels are engineered from strangely hybridized sea life, and their unstable tissues are constantly in a state of decay.

Stinkfish Wormbrain Core Feature: Jumbledguts

Once per round a Stinkfish may clear physical conditions currently affecting it by marking 1 stress per condition it wishes to clear. It may do so even if it currently suffers from a condition that impedes its ability to move or take actions normally.

All stress marked to clear conditions in this way must be marked at the same time (distributed however the Wormbrain wishes among its parts), and all conditions cleared in this way are cleared immediately, at the same time.



Zomboids

Zomboids are a Postgrad class of regenerative "undead" monsters. They are "born" from Zombies in various strange ways, borrowing genetic traits from carrion-eating flora or fauna, and mostly consist of "hyper-living" tissue that rapidly recovers from physical damage.

You can't create or alter Zomboids unless you're at respectability 5.

Zomboid Core Feature: Pretty Spry for a Dead Guy

A Zomboid doesn't *really* die- a Zomboid doesn't lose access to abilities if its parts break, it can't normally be destroyed, and even if it dies it doesn't stop moving, but if its core is broken it rolls only two dice on all rolls, all of its speeds are set to 1/2, it can't take reactions, and it is lobotomized. It is affected by any penalties from marked stress as normal,

and still counts as a corpse for any effect that interacts with corpses.

The Zomboid also suffers these penalties on any part that is broken, and can only use an ability on a broken part if that ability requires an action or a dice roll.

Monster Parts

Once you've chosen a class for your monster, you'll need to determine how many **body parts** it's going to have. Parts are important because they determine the structure of a monster and house its abilities. Your monster may have few body parts and just a couple of powerful abilities, or it may have a varied array of abilities spread across many parts.

Generally, monsters you create have a parts limit equal to your SCIENCE! attribute. Special abilities like the surgeon's core feature may increase this limit. **Your limit is how many parts a monster can have built onto its core.** If you capture, familiarize, or otherwise come into a monster whose number of parts *exceed* your limit, you can alter that monster, but can't change more parts at a time than your normal parts limit would allow.

In other words, if your parts limit is 7 and you alter a monster with 10 parts, you'd have to choose no more than 7 parts to adjust and leave the remaining 3 alone. If you remove parts from such a monster, you can't stick them back on if it would put the number of parts over your maximum. You're just not yet skilled enough to make it work right. Conversely, if a monster has *fewer* parts than your limit, you can add new ones up to your cap!

Parts are a highly flexible concept, and can be almost anything you want: Wings, tentacles, spikes, armored hides, gelatinous membranes, feelers, proboscides, eyeballs, or whatever else you can come up with—the name of a part is primarily a way to identify it in a stat block. Simply

put, it's your monster, so you get to decide what it looks like! This is true whether you're creating an entirely original monster from scratch, or altering a known species of monster like a Chainsaw Kid or Persephume.

Your monsters can include any parts you like, as long as you start with the **core** that determines their class. **A core doesn't count against your parts limit, has a single endurance box, and can't be directly altered,** nor can it be duplicated or mimicked on a monster. If the core is destroyed, the monster dies regardless of how many other functioning body parts it has remaining!

While planning your parts, you should also keep in mind your monster's **endurance**. Just like a mad scientist, monsters can only sustain so much stress before they're incapacitated or killed. Instead of applying stress to linear track of boxes, however, monsters mark stress they receive against individual body parts.

As a mad scientist, you have a pool of endurance boxes to distribute among the parts of any monster you create or alter. For a new monster you're making from scratch, you'll just assign endurance boxes to each part before moving on to the next step of the process. If you're altering a monster, it's similar to your parts limit: You can add additional endurance boxes to monsters with less than your maximum, but reducing parts or otherwise dropping the monster's current overall endurance means you can't go back over your limit, if that's where it started.

The number of endurance boxes you may allocate for any given monster is equal to (10 + your respectability). You can spread this out however you want among its parts, but no body part can have fewer than one endurance box—if it doesn't have any endurance, it can't exist as a part!

Whenever stress is inflicted on a monster, **the defender usually gets to allocate that stress among its parts however it wishes**. The attacker only gets to decide where stress goes if it has an understanding of the target's anatomy, typically via a full scanalysis. In this case, an attack targets a specific part and the "overflow" stress, if there is any, is still allocated by the defender. For example, if a monster marks 6 stress from an attack, but only has 2 endurance on the part that was targeted, the defender can split the remaining two stress across its parts as it wishes after the targeted part breaks. Certain blocks can modify or invalidate targeting and stress allocation- if a monster has [SHIELD] stress is always added to that part first regardless of either party's wishes, and neither party can choose to allocate stress to part with [INSULATE] unless enough other parts are already broken.

A player or NPC on the attack can always take a guess at what its target may have to attack, but the Proctor should not be overly generous when assessing targeting validity- a scientist can target "the wings", sure, but not "the part that makes fire" -they have to guess which part makes fire and aim for that! And if they try to aim for a part that has no mechanical effect, the defender gets to assign stress as it wishes.

Additionally, **a burst attack can never target a specific part, and a line or cone attack can only target a specific part on the first target in the line** (unless your monster has some way of targeting in the third person or seeing through its foes?)

Monsters suffer the same penalties from stress as scientists do (described in part one), taking -1 to their rolls for each fully marked box on the part or parts relevant to the rolls, such as when attacking or perceiving with that part. On defense, a monster only takes penalties to defend against an attack directly targeting that part.

When all endurance boxes on a part are broken, that part breaks and the ability can no longer be used unless the part is restored to functionality by erasing all the stress from at least one full box in one action. Only one of a monster's broken parts can be healed per action or effect, but any extra stress that can't be erased from that part can be removed from other unbroken parts as you please.

For example, let's say you create a monster with 3 parts (plus the core) and you have 15 endurance boxes to distribute among those parts, so you give each of them 5 endurance. When the monster suffers stress, it can break that stress up between those 3 parts however you like (in most cases). If 3 of a part's boxes are broken, that part would suffer a -3 penalty on all of its dice rolls. If all 5 of the boxes you allocated to a part suffer 2 stress, the part breaks and its ability immediately stops functioning.

As stated above, when a monster's core is broken (because it marks 2 stress in its lone endurance box), it dies regardless of how much stress is marked against its other parts.

A dead monster is a corpse, but it'll be fine once you make it back to your lair—dead monsters you own respawn at the beginning of downtime, just like dead PCs.

If all of a monster's body parts and the core are broken, the monster is destroyed rather than dead, and doesn't leave a corpse behind. It'll still be fine next time you go home, but there's no way to interact with it until then.

Thankfully, under normal circumstances, **a monster's core can't suffer stress until one-half of the monster's other parts (rounded down) are broken**. This "exposes" the core to danger so that it can be attacked; until the core is exposed, nothing generally affects it at all, and you can't assign stress to it when divvying up the damage dealt by incoming effects.

So, will your monster have just a couple of truly beefy parts, full of concentrated power? Or a plethora of parts with myriad abilities?

What Are "Cores?"

The core of a monster is for some purposes only a gameplay abstraction, but it can represent a variety of things depending on the class. In most classes including Bioconstructs, Botanicals, Biomecha, Biogarbage, Boo Men and Demishades, this innermost vital center is a sort of teratoma that produces Green Goo and inkhor to keep the monster going. In a Vampire, it's more like a shriveled up heart that houses their virus-like inner self. In a Joker, it's a mass of pulsing balloon-sacs that manufacture their thoughtwaft, and in a *Warped*, who knows what it could be. The important part is that it's only a *semi*-abstraction - it represents something, so that it can be destroyed or transplanted.

Monster Sizes

Once you've laid out a plan for your monster's body parts, it's time to choose its **size**. From smallest to largest, the different size categories are:

Miniscule → Tiny → Small → Average
→ Large → Enormous → Titanic

Mechanically, size determines the base range within which a creature can take actions (described in part 1) as well as a small default boost or penalty to defense against brawn attacks.

MINISCULE creatures have no range, and +3 defense to avoid brawn attacks. You have to purchase a range using blocks or similar before they can affect anything. Treat this as -3. A cockroach, a hummingbird or a mouse would qualify as miniscule.

TINY creatures have a base range of contact, meaning they have to be right up against something to interact. Treat this as -2. They also have a +2 defense to avoid brawn attacks. Crows, rats and housecats would qualify as tiny.

SMALL creatures' base range is -1, affecting only engaged targets, and a +1 defense to avoid brawn attacks. A toddler, a goat or a tortoise would be considered small.

Your **AVERAGE** creature starts with a base range of 0 or close by, and no defense bonus or penalty. Adult humans, timberwolves and cassowaries are some "average" sized creatures in our world (though the cassowary is surely on the upper end of this).

LARGE creatures have a base range of 1, and -1 to defense against brawn attacks, **as larger sizes make easier targets**. Think in terms of a horse, an alligator, or a porpoise.

ENORMOUS creatures' base range is 2, and they have -2 defense against brawn attacks. Giraffes, real-world elephants, and spinosaurs are "enormous."

TITANIC creatures have a range of 3 for everything they can do, and -3 defense vs brawny attacks. A blue whale, a brachiosaurus, and some smaller kaiju are "titanic."

Remember, if a scene's scale feels too large that these ranges seem improbably long, you can always add more zones to convey the scale!

Monster Parts & Endurance Review:

The maximum number of body parts from which your monsters may be composed is equal to your SCIENCE!.

A monster has 1 core that determines its class; the core always has just 1 endurance box, and doesn't count as a body part.

You may allocate endurance boxes equal to (10 + your respectability) among a monster's body parts. No part may have fewer than 1 box.

Defenders may distribute stress among their body parts however they wish. A part suffers -1 per broken box on all dice rolls it makes. When all of a part's endurance boxes are marked broken, the whole part is broken and its ability can't be used until it's repaired, usually only by healing an entire endurance box at once. Only one part can be restored from broken per action or effect.

Attacking monsters may only allocate stress if they can identify the target's body parts, but are allowed to make guesses. An attacker can never allocate stress on targets of a burst attack or extra targets of a line attack, and other blocks may modify stress allocation allowance.

A core can't usually suffer stress until it's exposed after one-half the monster's body parts (rounded down) are broken.

When a monster's core becomes broken, it dies. If its core and all its body parts are broken, it's destroyed instead, leaving no corpse that can be iteracted with. A dead or destroyed monster respawns at your lair at the beginning of the next downtime period.

Monster Attributes (brains & brawn)

You've got your monster roughed out with class, parts, and size; now it's time to figure out exactly what it can do. Enter the monstrous attributes: **Brains** and **Brawn**.

These are very similar to your own attributes as a mad scientist, but broader and simpler: **A monster rolls +Brains when attempting any primarily mental task** (such as picking a computer lock or doing the accounting at the end of the month), **and +Brawn when it attempts any primarily physical task** (like bashing down a door or holding a yoga pose). For fun, though, **Brains is also the attribute for physical tasks that rely on preparation beforehand**, like poisoning someone with your homemade toxins, or **if your literal, physical brain is involved in a task**, like if you're trying to beat someone to death with it.

Monsters also roll either +Brains or +Brawn when defending, depending on what's most appropriate for the situation—dodging out of the way would be Brawn, for instance, because that's a physical action, while resisting a fear effect would be Brains since it's psychological. The Proctor is the final arbiter of which attribute you need to roll on defense.

Add your SCIENCE! and MADNESS! scores together to determine the total points you can spend on a monster's attributes. For example, if you have 4 in SCIENCE! and 3 in MADNESS!, you would have 7 points to invest in your monster's Brains and Brawn. Divide these points as you see fit between the two attributes, based on what feels right for the monster and what kinds of things you'd like for it to excel at. Neither attribute can have a score less than 1.

You separately spend an identical pool of points to purchase the monster's abilities. So, if you have 7 points to split between Brains and Brawn, you also have 7 points to share between all of your creation's body parts when designing abilities. Some features or discoveries may increase this allowance without increasing a monster's actual Brains and Brawn attributes; just make a note of such bonuses when you get to this step.

If a monster joins you with an attribute or ability pool that's already greater than your maximum, you can still alter that monster with a project, but you can't change its Brains or Brawn scores or redistribute its ability points. If removing abilities from it reduces its total ability points to your normal cap or below, you can't put them back in and exceed your maximum.

Finally, keep in mind that if a monster's Brains attribute exceeds (your MADNESS! score + your respectability), it may become disobedient, and you'll have to roll +DISCOURSE! against the monster's Brains to convince it to listen to you. **A disobedient monster acts according to its class, nature, and personality, doing its own thing rather than what you ask it to do.**

Monster Attributes Review:

A monster has points to allocate to its attributes equal to (your SCIENCE! score + your MADNESS! score).

Monster attributes are Brains and Brawn. You roll +Brains or +Brawn depending on whether a task is physical or mental, including when defending against effects.

A monster also has ability points equal to (your SCIENCE! score + your MADNESS! score), which are used to purchase ability blocks to make customized abilities per body part.

Abilities

Time for the really fun part: Customizing your monster's abilities! Abilities are crafted using **ability blocks** with specific functions, which you buy using the monster's ability point pool (equal to the attribute point pool you already divided between Brains and Brawn, as described above).

You can only use ability blocks you know, so keep track of your known blocks on your character sheet! Your mad scientist starts out knowing all the ability blocks used in their initial Demishade or other starter monster,

and can learn more by trading with or purchasing from peers and by scanalyzing living monsters. **When you achieve a complete scanalysis of a monster, you learn any ability blocks it's using that you don't already know.**

Blocks fall into three categories: **Active, passive, and enhancement.** Active blocks must be used as a major action to have any effect, unless modified by an enhancement block. Passive blocks provide a persistent effect with no action required, or automatically create a specific effect in reaction to some kind of triggering condition, for as long as their body part is operational. Enhancement blocks don't do anything on their own, but can be attached to other blocks to change their effects.

When you construct an ability, you usually start with a single active or passive block—you can't use both in the same body part, and you can't use more than one of either type in the same body part. Then you're free to add as many enhancement blocks as you want (and can afford) to round out the ability, including doubling up for multiple effects (like by selecting [REACH] to increase an ability's range by +1, then buying it again to increase the same ability's range by another +1, for a total of +2). You purchase the ability by investing points from the monster's ability allowance into the ability, which gives that ability its own modifiers or dice pool to determine effectiveness. Remember that **each body part can only hold a single ability**, so plan carefully and consider what your monster might lose access to if a part is broken!

On that note: Just like a monster can have parts with no abilities installed, you're also free to replicate an ability in multiple body parts. If a monster's number of actions per turn doesn't change, then what's the value in this? Well, **you add identical abilities together when determining their total effect**, and if one of those body parts is broken, you still have part of the ability left over! If you had [ARMOR +2 brains] in two separate body parts, for instance, you'd actually add +4 to your roll result when defending with Brains as long as both parts are operational; if one of them is broken, you'd still add +2!

Each block you add to an ability has a base cost of 1 point from the monster's point allowance, and no block can cost less than 1 die.

Many ability blocks allow you to spend additional points for increased effect, while others offer a static benefit for a flat cost. You choose how your ability works by deciding how many points to spend on it.

For example, let's say you want to give your monster a poison splash as an attack. You'd start with the [DAMAGE] block, which lets you choose a type of damage—in this case, "toxic." It costs a minimum of 1 point from the monster's ability pool to buy the [DAMAGE] block. Then, you'd need to add the [CLEAVE] enhancement block to choose "burst" as the area of effect, and possibly [REACH] to improve the range to 1. At 1 point each from the ability pool, that brings the total cost to 3 points for the finished ability.

You could stop there, meaning the monster would now be able to use a major action to deal toxic damage in a burst within short range using 3d10 dice (since you spent 1 point on the [DAMAGE] block, adding 1d10 to your normal 2d10 attack roll). If you'd then like to have the toxins to inflict a withering effect for continuing damage over time, you'd spend a point to attach the [APPEND] enhancement block to the [DAMAGE] block for a more complex but more expensive ability. You could also invest extra points into [DAMAGE] for a stronger attack, attach the [REACH] block a second or even third time to give your monster some real range, and so on.

When designing new monsters, it's up to you to describe their appearance and to justify how an ability assigned to a given body part functions. A gaze attack, for instance, might originate from eyes in the monster's head or strange eye-like glands throughout its hide. A cloud of noxious vapors or caustic chemicals might be the monster belching from an orifice or spores fanned by its wings. An armored monster might have a thick, bony carapace to thank, but could just as easily absorb damage by being soft and spongy.

Premade Parts

During your adventures you may purchase, recover, or even steal fully-intact monster parts. You can record the ability and endurance of the monster parts on your character sheet, and then if you use that part exactly as it is when building a monster, you can reduce the cost and project goal of making or editing that monster by the value of the part. When you edit a monster and remove or replace an ability altogether, you can add the part with the old ability to your inventory to sell or use again later!

Weaknesses

...And if you want to, you can also voluntarily give your monster one or more weaknesses in exchange for bonus ability points. **A weakness isn't attached to a specific body part and doesn't take up space like an ability.** It's typically an inversion of a passive ability block, which naturally has the reverse effect. **You choose how many points you want to get from weaknesses, up to one-half of the monster's total ability allowance (rounded down).** The number you pick for each weakness is the penalty for that weakness, but you also add that many points to the monster's ability point pool and can allocate them into other abilities.

The easiest weaknesses to set up are those that grant a clear numerical benefit; for example, since [ARMOR +2 radiation] normally adds +2 to your monster's result when defending against radiation, selecting it as [ARMOR -2 radiation] would instead reduce that same result by -2, and you'd get 2 bonus ability points to spend on other stuff.

Another very common weakness type instead grants a bonus to the other guy when you find yourself in a contest, as discussed previously in the various rules pages. As a refresher, you may denote a weakness with an => arrow instead of a - minus to denote that the weakness grants a bonus to someone else rather than a direct penalty to your monster. When dealing with abilities that add extra dice, you always use => weaknesses. For example the [RESIST +3d10 chemical] block normally gives a monster +3 dice when defending against chemical damage; as a weakness [RESIST =>3d10 chemical], it would therefore cause a chemical effect to add +3 dice to its pool on offense and give you 3 more points.

Think of it as saying "when this monster tries to [RESIST chemical], the opponent (=>) adds +3d10."

When a monster with an =>arrow weakness attempts a static challenge, the challenge becomes a contest, and the obstacle rolls dice equal to your monster's weakness and then adds its challenge rating to the result. An obstacle cannot botch in this way.

Regardless, **you don't need to know a block to use it as a weakness, nor do you learn the normal version when you scanalyze a monster with a weakness** (because a weakness is a characteristic added to a monster, not a block).

You're theoretically allowed as many weaknesses as you want, so long as they don't exceed your allowed maximum; each one could then be less severe—but **the maximum bonus points you can get from all your weaknesses together is still one-half the monster's default ability allowance from your SCIENCE! and MADNESS! (rounded down), that is, you don't adjust for any discovery or core feature that alters the points you can spend, unless it explicitly says to.**

Monster Abilities Review:

Abilities are constructed by purchasing ability blocks, using the monster's available ability points. Each discrete block or instance of the same block costs at least 1 ability point.

Ability blocks are either active (requiring an action to use), passive (always on or automatic), or enhancement (changing how another block works). All abilities start with and contain either a single active or passive block, plus any number of enhancement blocks. Any body part may only hold a single monster ability.

Identical abilities installed in separate body parts are added together to determine their total effect. If any of the constituent body parts are broken or otherwise disabled, you continue to use the remaining operational body parts to determine the effect of the ability.

You may choose to add one or more weaknesses to a monster in exchange for bonus ability points, equal to the total penalty of those weaknesses. Weaknesses aren't attached to a body part; they affect an entire monster.

Weaknesses cannot exceed half the monster's total base ability points! (equal to its Brains + its Brawn) (rounded down). Do not account for scientist abilities unless told to by that ability.

Monster Costs

To get the project goal for manufacturing a monster, we use a simple formula:

(Brains + Brawn) x class modifier

This is closely derived from the formula for scanalysis goals, so you should get used to it quickly! To determine data costs, just take this number and multiply it by 5.

This price and research rolls are an abstraction of the time, studying, experimentation, laboratory equipment, consultation with peers, sourcing components, and all the other stuff that goes into making your monster. Once you've paid the appropriate amount of data, you can begin the project to create or alter your monster. When you finish the project, you've created life! And the monster is immediately ready to join your adventures.

Remember, if you create a brand new Demishade, it can't perform research on the same downtime as it was born, of course.

Monster Class Multipliers:

Normal, x2: Arthropoid, Bioconstruct, Biogabrage, Biomech, Botanical, Demishade, Wormbrain

Postgrad, x3: Ectophasm, Fectoid, Vampire, Zomboid

Esoterror, x4: Boo Man, Devilbird, Joker, Warped

(You can't make Vampires or Boo Men from scratch, though!)

Altering Existing Monsters

Just because you didn't make the monster from scratch doesn't mean you can't make a few tweaks here and there, and even if you did make it, you're going to keep perfecting it as your skills improve, right?

If you're altering a monster instead of building one from scratch, the process is pretty much the same, but you count points instead of Brains and Brawn, because **you only have to pay for and research the parts you're actually changing.** However, this means the process of calculating your project goals and data cost is slightly different if your monster has any weakness bonus points. When calculating the cost/goal of editing a monster, you still have to pay for points you got from weaknesses.

This is because there's no way to track which of the points on your monster come from weaknesses and which come from Brains and Brawn. So, you pay either way. But this way, you can spend less time and data to make incremental changes to a monster, or take your time on a gradiose adjustment for a brand new ability never before seen. If you're going to reinvent the monster entirely from the ground up, though, it's probably best to start from scratch.

So, the project goal for editing a monster is:

(points + endurance) x Class multiplier, but only on the parts you actually change in some way.

...And as with other projects, you determine the data cost by multiplying this result by 5.

You can also change your monsters' weaknesses when editing them, if it's your original creation. Remember that when editing a monster that you didn't make, you can't change its weaknesses, nor can you change any quirk, obsession, or affinity it may have.

Earlier, we talked about adding premade monster parts to your monsters, discounting the cost and project goal by the amount on the part. **If that amount is "all of it,"** you spend one research action and finish the project immediately.

And one more thing- **you can still edit a monster you aren't skilled enough to create, but you must choose to either change only endurance, or bring it down to your level.**

Sample Monster Build

That's a lot of information to parse, so let's walk through the step-by-step process and see how it all comes together. We'll start with a generic mad scientist of respectability 1, with 4 in SCI-ENCE! and 3 in MADNESS!, which means:

- Their parts limit when making a monster is 4.
- They can distribute up to 11 endurance between all body parts (10 + their respectability of 1).
- They can spend up to 7 points on Brains and Brawn, and thus 7 points on abilities.

Let's say our basic blueprint will be an average-sized Bioconstruct. Our esteemed colleague Dr. Regularius Generic doesn't want any given body part to be too fragile, so they decide on only 3 parts, two of them with 4 endurance each and the last with 3 endurance. They assign a Brains score of 2 and a Brawn of 5—the monster won't be too smart, but there'll be no real risk of disobedience (since Brains 2 is less than Dr. Generic's MADNESS! score of 3).

Because it has 3 body parts, the monster can also have up to 3 abilities (1 per part). Dr. Generic knows several ability blocks that came with their original YGORE, plus some shared by their think tank. They want a mobile monster that can clear difficult terrain, that's hard to kill, and that spews noxious vapors at enemies. They decide to make something that's kind of like a flying sand dollar, with a hard outer shell and gas-spouting orifices. The monster's layout looks like this:

- Skeleton
- Gas bladder
- Vents

There are 7 points to spend on customizing abilities between the parts, so Dr. Generic has to be efficient. They decide to take a single point of weakness to bring it up to match the think tank's other 8 point monsters. They decide to break it down this way:

- Core: [Splice of Life core feature]
- Skeleton: [RESIST +1d10 physical]
- Gas bladder: [MOVE hover][DASH +1]
- Vents: [DAMAGE +2d10 toxic/brawn][APPEND corrupted][CLEAVE 2 burst, line]
- Weakness: [RESIST =>1d10 thermal]

Thanks to its tough skeleton, this monster may only roll 2d10+2 when defending with Brains, but rolls a respectable 3d10+5 Brawn when defending against physical stress—at least until its skeleton is broken. It will have a hover speed of 1, levitating on gas jets to hover over difficult terrain. Finally, it will be able to fire puffs of toxic fumes in a cone with a range of 0 (so, just foes in the same zone, but several of them), rolling 4d10+5 for the attack (from its [DAMAGE] and its Brawn, since this isn't a mental attack); anything caught in the blast will suffer toxic stress and gain a stack of the corrupted condition for a turn.

In order to squeeze in that last ability point, Dr. Generic decides it makes sense for a monster full of gas to be especially flammable, so foes roll an extra die when attacking it thermally.

Now Dr. Generic only needs to know what their creation will cost, in time and data. Since it will have 11 total endurance and a total of 7 Brains and Brawn together and is a simple Bioconstruct, this monster will take 36 research (11+7=18, x2=36) to create and cost them 180 data (36x5) to produce in their lair.

That sounds like a perfectly reasonable expenditure to our mad scientist, so at the beginning of their next downtime period, they spend the 160 data and begin a new project to grow the monster. When the project reaches completion, they'll have a brand-new, delightfully ghastly friend able to join their adventures right away!



Whirling Fumigator

AEROFOUL

Five narrow, humanlike eyes encircle this roughly discoid monster, alternating with respiratory vents reminiscent of piglike snouts. Its upper surface is a five-lobed, colorfully splotched shell, while its snouts and its lower surface are covered in lumpy, wrinkled skin.

BIOLOGY:

The Aerofooul's simplicity suggests an early experiment in the career of its indeterminate creator, and its sudden, rapid spread is indicative of a relatively recent one. A fused, compact skeleton constitutes most of its body mass, its bone tissues consisting of a fine silicon-reinforced nanolattice as durable as steel but nearly lighter than air, permitting the monster to levitate freely as its sixteen lungs continually draw air through its single dorsal intake and out through its lateral vents. Feeding on the dense chemicals of Mortasheen's smog cover, the Aerofooul's only digestive by-product is a refined powder of nitrogen oxides, methane and chemo-synthetic bacteria it stores within a secondary ring of more specialized lung sacs. When agitated or startled, it floods these sacs with a salivary secretion, churns the waste powder into a fine froth and exhales it into a heavy, sticky smokescreen. The intense fumes are sickening even to many other specialized smog-eaters, and extensive enough inhalation can be life threatening to less adaptable monsters.

A mature and well-fed specimen may begin to undergo asexual fission, gradually developing into two mirrored individuals over the course of only a few weeks.

BEHAVIOR:

The Aerofooul's minimal soft tissues are hardly worth the hassle for most predators, and it lacks fear altogether, but it is irritated by intrusion into its personal space and quickly angered by unwanted touch. This is unfortunately not a two-way concern, as the highly curious, easily bored Aerofooul enjoys following, watching, nudging, or even landing atop other creatures for extended periods of time.

Though its concentration of methane is highly combustible, an Aerofooul is attracted to open flame, cautiously savoring the flavor of smoke.



Scanalysis Goal: 14
BRAINS: 2
BRAWN: 5

AEROFOUL - AVERAGE BIOCONSTRUCT		Parts (3)	Endurance (11)
Shelleton		Skeleton	4
[RESIST +1d10 physical]			
Smog Skimmer		Gas Bladder	4
[MOVE hover][DASH +1]			
Gasblaster		Vents	3
[DAMAGE +2d10 toxic/brawn][APPEND corrupted][CLEAVE 2 burst, line]			
Weakness: Fire Hazard [RESIST =>1d10 thermal]			
QUIRK: Uninvited Flying Object			

Ability Blocks

Unless altered by an enhancement block, active blocks require a major action to use or activate. **Whenever any ability requires a dice roll, the roll is +Brains or +Brawn by the monster using the ability, unless specified otherwise by the block description.**

Likewise, unless specified otherwise, **all blocks which rely on a dice roll start with a standard pool of 2 dice, plus additional dice equal to the points spent on that block.**

Block Name	Effect
Active Blocks	
Assimilate	Change target's core to same as yours
Assist	Grant ally bonus on tasks
Bolster	Grant ally ability
Buzzkill	Clear ongoing swarm
Charge	Charge gadget or power electrical attack
Copy	Mimic ability used since last turn
Create	Produce consumable gadget
Cure	Remove condition
Damage	Inflict stress
Deceive	Create illusory effect
Decompose	Consume corpse to heal
Engulf	Envelop targets
Express	Communicate clearly during combat
Forbid	Make chosen action impossible
Hinder	Inflict vulnerability
Inflict	Inflict condition
Invade	Enter monster's body like a parasite
Puppet	Take control of target's actions
Reclaim	Consume own spawn to heal
Repair	Clear own stress
Scavenge	Assimilate ability from corpse
Spawn	Produce other monsters
Swarm	Unleash damaging area condition
Transfuse	Spend endurance to heal ally
Vanish	Disappear
Passive Blocks	
Adapt	Gain environmental survival trait
Armor	Increase defense result against certain attack
Corral	Gain bonus dice to help certain class
Cull	Gain bonus dice to harm certain class
Empty	Give no health when drained
Encore	Gain extra use of core feature
Engage	Gain bonus when performing chosen type of task
Impress	Gain reputation with specific audience
Lure	Prevent swarm from damaging others
Move	Gain a movement speed

Muffle	Become undetectable by sense
Perceive	Gain advanced senses
Protect	Take stress in another's place
Rampage	Gain roll bonus but monster must either attack or do nothing
Recover	Reduce duration of condition
Regenerate	Clear stress over time
Resist	Increase defense dice against certain attack
Enhancement Blocks	
Absorb	Effect type clears stress
Aggregate	Charge swarm ahead of time
Append	Ability inflicts limited condition
Armamentify	Broken part becomes gadget
Awaken	Stress relief can raise the dead
Blink	Ability cannot be reacted to
Cast	Ability is routed through another source
Change	Ability alters traits of affected targets
Cleave	Ability becomes area of effect
Cling	Ability becomes a grappling attack
Combine	Add extra descriptors
Command	Psychic attack or express gains modes
Compound	Purchase active or passive block as enhancement
Concoct	Chemical or toxic attack wildcard
Counter	Ability is performed as a reaction
Dash	Increase linked movement speed
Detonate	Obliterate part for strong double dice.
Disclude	Remove targets from area effect
Discriminate	Ability effect is different on specific target
Drain	Ability clears stress when effective
Emanate	Linked ability becomes a field effect
Endure	Increase part's endurance
Expand	Burst or emanate becomes whole zone
Fester	Passive ability works while dead
Flatten	Ability smooths difficult terrain
Hijack	Ability is used by invaded monster, not you
Ignore	Limited immunity to damage type or condition
Insulate	Affected part can't suffer stress until core is exposed
Link	Add power that is lost with other part
Penetrate	Ability ignores targeting restriction
Pierce	Ability decreases defender's result
Phase	Ability ignores barriers
Prepare	Transfer or concoct begins with ability
Reach	Improves range of linked ability

Recoil	Improves power of ability at cost
Respond	Ability becomes conditional response
Sample	Ability gathers scanalysis and data
Shamble	Ability can be used limited times when dead
Share	Ability can be loaned to ally
Shed	Part can be dropped as spawn
Shield	Part takes stress before others
Shunt	Forcibly relocate target
Spout	Drain or sample empowers ability
Squeeze	Ability acts as if source is smaller
Sustain	Improve duration of ability
Tend	Self-target ability can be used on others
Transfer	Ability steals and reapplies conditions
Transplant	Core is hidden in this part
Trample	Ability occurs when moving past targets
Upscale	Ability acts as if source is larger
Wander	Add movement to some abilities

Active Blocks

[ASSIMILATE]

As a major action, the monster can make an attack roll with bonus dice equal to the points invested in this block against a target within reach. If it succeeds on this attack, the target becomes the same class as the attacker, losing access to its previous core feature.

This lasts until the next downtime, or until an alchemist spends a mutation to cure the condition.

If the monster is a Bioconstruct, Demishade, or Boo Man, the target's new core feature has the same Quirk, Affinity, or Obsession as the attacker.

Example: Placed on a Wormbrain, this ability could be used to grant allies the ability to purge themselves of mental conditions, at the cost of losing their existing feature.

If a demimonster or gadget with no core feature uses this ability, or if you use this ability as a mad scientist... nothing happens, sorry. You can't assimilate a monster to not have a core feature, or one that relies on attributes it doesn't have. But an electrician's gadget will work if it has Quicker Fusion Frequency from the Quick on the Drawing Board discovery.

[ASSIST]

When you create this ability, choose a single type or category of task. This monster can use a minor action to aid another character on such a task, so long it could reasonably provide assistance. Doing so adds a number of bonus dice to that character's dice pool for that roll equal to the points spent on this block.

Example: [ASSIST +2d10 laundering][REACH +2][CLEAVE line]

This monster has to ability to help every scientist at once in a line within three zones of its location to... do the laundry?

[BOLSTER]

When you create this ability, either build any other ability with points equal to the points invested in this block, or choose an enhancement block. As a major action, you can grant an ally within range (but not yourself) a condition that allows it to use the ability you designed. or to add that enhancement block to all its abilities as appropriate. This special condition lasts until the end of the scene unless it is ended by another effect, such as an enemy targeting you with [CURE].

Example: [BOLSTER 4 (REGENERATE 4)]

A simple injection of reconstructive nanomons allow this monster to grant its allies potent regeneration.

[BUZZKILL]

As a major action, this monster may clear an ongoing swarm.

[CHARGE]

As a minor action, the monster can clear 1 stress from a gadget within reach per point invested in [CHARGE], or as a major action it can add +1 dice to a target's next attack with the electrical descriptor per point invested in [CHARGE]. This dice bonus lasts only until this monster's next turn.

[COPY]

This monster can use a major action to mimic any ability used by another monster within range since the end of its last turn. The mimicked ability functions identically to the original in all ways, including point distribution, range, area of effect, duration, additional effects, and so on. An ability can only be mimicked in this way if its total point cost is equal to or less than the points spent on this block.

If the details of the mimicked ability are unknown to this monster's controlling mad scientist, the Proctor will relay whether it can be mimicked, what modifiers to add, and otherwise assist with determining the appropriate outcome.

Example: Psychodrome uses [COPY 11] to be able to mirror the effects of nearly anything it sees another monster do.

[CREATE]

When you create this ability, design a creation to be manufactured. Once this creation has been designed, it can't be changed unless this monster is altered, so this ability produces the same creation every time.

This monster can use a major action to produce a creation within range, which is a type of simplified mini-gadget. Creations act as normal gadgets except for the following attributes:

- Creations are always consumable gadgets, and do not mark stress against parts. Using any ability of the creation marks stress as normal, but all stress is marked on the same endurance box, as if all of its abilities were housed on the same part.
If you spend points to give a creation the [ENDURE] block, it adds another endurance box to its single endurance track, like a scientist.
- It does not benefit from any discoveries that alter how you can build gadgets.
- When the creation must make a dice roll without being wielded by any character, it uses a bonus equal to the points invested in this block.
- Otherwise, build a gadget that has points equal to those spent on this block.

Example Creation: Manspider Silk +3

[INFLECT +1d10 fettered][REACH+1] ; [ENGAGE +1d10 climbing]

Vertigo's silken cables can be used as a lasso to tie up enemies, or as a rope for climbing.

[CURE]

This monster can use a major action to clear from itself a number of conditions or other negative status effects of its choice equal to the points spent on this block.

If the target of this ability is affected by a Fectoid's infection phase, instead treat this ability as an attack against the Fectoid with bonus dice equal to the points invested in this block. If the attack is a success, the Fectoid marks typeless stress and is immediately removed from its host and returned to its macroform.

Example: [CURE 1][TEND][APPEND eroding:necrotic]

Judging by the rot this causes when used, this monster is specialized to fight Fectoids instead of cure its allies.

[DAMAGE]

When you create this ability, choose a single damage type from chemical, cryonic, electrical, kinetic, necrotic, physical, psychic, radiation, thermal, or toxic. Likewise, choose either Brains or Brawn. This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target within range, adding dice to their pool equal to the points spent on this block and a bonus to their final result equal to the chosen attribute. If the attack is successful, it inflicts stress of the chosen damage type.

For example, a physical attack made with [DAMAGE +2d10 cryonic] and a Brawn attribute of 5 would roll 4 dice, take the best result, and add +5.

Each damage type has slightly different effects, detailed in the combat section, and you learn each damage type as if it were a separate block.

So, if you scanalyze a Repulsate, you would learn [DAMAGE radioactive] and [DAMAGE thermal], but not any of the other eight types you don't know.



[DECEIVE]

This monster can use a major action to generate an illusory effect within range. The effect can be of this monster's size or smaller, and can incorporate sensory input (such as sight, sound, smell, or psigital signature) for up to 1 sense per point spent on this block. If a target interacts with the illusion, the illusion gains bonus dice equal to the points spent on this block, regardless of whether it rolls on offense or defense. The effect ends at the beginning of this monster's next turn.

Example: [DECEIVE +2d10 ultrasound, x-ray]

They all laughed when Doctor Klobbe gave his monster the ability to create illusions only detectable to certain equipment, and he couldn't even say they'd all see. But he still had the last laugh when his rival tried to use a radiographic scope to steal his latest breakthrough.

[DECOMPOSE]

As a major action, this monster eats from a corpse within reach. For each point of decompose, mark a third point of stress on a broken endurance box on the corpse, and then clear all stress from an equal amount of your own endurance boxes. The "overmarked" boxes can't be healed until the monster's next downtime, and are otherwise subject to the same rulings as obliteration. You can't clear stress if you can't mark any boxes.

[ENGULF]

This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target within range, with bonus dice equal to the points spent on this block. If the attack is successful, the target is enveloped in some fashion, as long as it's at least one size smaller. An engulfed target's speed becomes 0 for all types of movement unless it can phase through its captor somehow, and it's automatically affected at the beginning of each of its turns by any attached enhancement blocks, as appropriate.

Defense against engulf never applies size-based defense modifiers. An enveloped target can escape from this monster with a successful opposed roll, made by the target as a major action, and the engulfing monster's [ENGULF] bonus is added to their roll.

If an ability with [ENGULF] also has [DRAIN], instead of clearing stress upon a successful engulf attack, the monster engulfing clears half the stress marked by the monster it has engulfed.

[EXPRESS]

When you create this ability, choose a manner of expression such as speech, telecerebral messaging, or sign. If the manner of communication is exceptionally strange, such as pheromonal or electromagnetic communication, it also gains the ability to understand this type of communication. This monster may use a minor action to communicate clearly to other characters who would understand its method of communication, even during a stressful scenario. Without this block, monsters cannot coherently communicate under duress. The usual rules of communication apply- one minor action equals six words. As a major action, it may also use this mode of communication as a vehicle for any linked enhancement blocks, using a dice pool equal to two plus the points spent on this block, affecting targets within range as appropriate. For instance, this might mean speaking in a seductive manner to inflict the charmed condition via [APPEND]. This monster can still choose to communicate without using any attached enhancements as a minor action. Additionally, this monster may participate in spirited debate if it can be understood. Any stress suffered as a result of social attack and defense rolls must be marked against this part; when this part is broken, this monster can no longer participate in spirited debate, and any "overflow" stress is lost.

Example: [EXPRESS +1d10 radio waves][REACH +1]

Eyegore can understand radio communication, but you'll need to be creative to make good use of its ability to respond to them in kind.

Remember, monsters in a spirited debate only use half their brains, rounded down! They won't have the same priorities that scientists find convincing, but may have an advantage in being imposing.

[FORBID]

When you create this ability, choose a specific activity. This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target within range, with bonus dice equal to the points spent on this block. If the attack is successful, the target becomes unable to undertake the chosen activity until the end of the scene. This effect counts as a condition that can be cured, and the block does not count as having descriptors, so it cannot be modified by [CHANGE] or the Per Mutation core feature.

Example: [FORBID +2d10 gastrointestinal abilities][APPEND ruptured][SUSTAIN +2]

You rip the guts out of your target, and now on top of the terrible bleeding, they can't vomit acid, devour you, or even so much as flatulate until something sews their intestines back on.

[HINDER]

When you create this ability, choose a weakness as described earlier in part 4. This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target within range. If the attack is successful, the target gains the chosen weakness as a condition. The penalty or other value of this effect equals the points spent on this block; for example, spending 4 points on this block could translate to [RESIST =>4] when defending against electrical damage or the charmed condition, and so on.

This effect lasts until the end of the current scene, counts as a condition that can be cured, and the block does not count as having descriptors, so it cannot be modified by [CHANGE] or the Per Mutation core feature.

[INFLICT]

When you create this ability, choose a single condition. This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target within range, using a dice pool equal to the points spent on this block. If the attack is successful, the target gains the chosen condition until the end of the scene. You may choose the damage type of the stress inflicted by the eroding or ruptured condition.

You learn each condition descriptor as if it were a separate block, but learn the relevant [APPEND] descriptor at the same time if you know [APPEND].

See [DAMAGE] for more details.

[INVADE]

This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target within range, using a bonus dice pool equal to the points spent on this block. If the attack is successful, this monster enters the target in some fashion, as long as it is at least one size smaller. An invaded monster is automatically affected at the beginning of each of its turns by any attached enhancement blocks, as appropriate. The attack roll automatically succeeds against a target that is engulfing you.

An invading monster cannot be attacked without damaging its host unless the attack has the [PENETRATE] block, or its host's core is exposed. It takes half of all stress its host does, except for stress that it causes, and cannot take any major actions except to leave its host.

An invading monster is ejected from its host if its core becomes exposed while it is invading, or if it dies within its host.

See also the [HIJACK] block.

[PUPPET]

When you create this ability, choose either living creatures, corpses, or objects. This monster can use a major action to make an attack against a single target of the chosen type within range, using a dice pool equal to the points spent on this block plus two. If the attack is successful, this monster takes control of the target. Most corpses and objects can't defend against this ability unless already controlled by another effect.

While something is controlled in this way, this monster determines the affected target's actions, essentially taking their turn for them while the effect lasts. A controlled target acts on its controller's turn while it remains affected. Controlling a creature on your turn is a major action, unless you have multiple creatures controlled, in which case you may spend a major action to control the first, and then minor actions to command two more. A controlled creature is usually aware that it is being manipulated and remembers what it did during that time, though this may not always be the case (such as when this monster rolls a crit to use this ability, or the target rolls a botch defending against it).

If the puppet is a thinking creature, control breaks as soon as you do not spend an action to take the target's turn, and it can also be cured by the [CURE] block. When a character stops being controlled, it may act immediately if it skipped its turn this round.

A spawn or creation given [PUPPET] puppeteers on behalf of its parent monster, and a gadget with [PUPPET] puppeteers on behalf of its wielder. Whoever the entity is puppeteering "on behalf of" has to spend its actions to puppeteer the victim. Adding [FESTER] to [PUPPET] allows a monster to continue puppeteering an already enthralled victim even after it dies.

A spawn or creation [PUPPET]s on behalf of its creator, so the creator maintains puppetry if the spawn or creation dies.

[RECLAIM]

As a major action, this monster may destroy a spawn or gadget it created within range and clear as much stress as it would if it made the spawn or gadget's last drain attack. For example, if a spawn just attacked a monster with a [DRAIN] ability and dealt 6 stress, reclaiming it would clear 3 stress.

Example: [RECLAIM][CLEAVE 2 burst, line][REACH +1]

This monster can vacuum up all its spawn in a wide cone to reclaim the nutrition they've gathered for itself.

[REPAIR]

This monster can use a major action to clear an amount of stress up to the points spent on this block.

Remember, you can only unbreak one broken part per action or effect!

[SCAVENGE]

As a major action, you may steal a broken part from a corpse within reach and replace this ability with the ability on that part. Cross that part out- it's been obliterated and can't be healed until downtime.

If a Biomech scavenges a Brain, it immediately equips the brain to its extra part from Plug and Play.

[SPAWN]

When you create this ability, design a spawn to be, uh, spawned. Once this spawn has been designed, it can't be changed unless this monster is altered, so this ability produces the same spawn every time.

This monster can use a major action to produce a spawn within range. Spawns last until destroyed (they never leave a corpse) and act on this monster's turn. A spawn has the following characteristics:

- Its class is Demimonster, because it has no core and thus it does not have a core feature. The exception is that spawns spawned by Worm-brains will be Wormbrains.
- It has no endurance boxes, and does not mark stress against parts. When the spawn marks stress, it dies immediately, leaving no corpse. If you spend points to give a spawn the [ENDURE] block, it gains a single endurance track, like a scientist, with a number of boxes equal to the number of points spent on that block.
- A Spawn cannot have a weakness, and does not benefit from any other discoveries that alter how you can build monsters.
- Otherwise, build a monster that has Brains and Brawn totaling the points spent on this block, and an equal amount of ability points as normal. Unlike a normal monster, a spawn can have 0 in one of its attributes if you only spend one point on this block.

For the purposes of effects that require a target, the target of [SPAWN] is the spawn.

If players want to bring spawns that have already been spawned into another scene, roll 2d10 and take the lower number- up to this many surviving spawn accompany you to the next scene. If you get ambushed, none of them do, and your monster had better get spawning!

[SWARM]

As a major action, you can unleash a swarm, an area condition that hits every character on the ground except for its user by unleashing many little creatures. Select a damage type for your swarm among the normal damage types. A swarm deals 1 damage to every part of every monster (**but never the core!**) and 1 damage to every scientist, with no defense roll, and additionally imparts a -1 penalty to specific types of rolls (based on its damage type) to all characters it damages; if a character is vulnerable to the swarm's damage type, it receives -1 more point of penalty per point of weakness, and if resistant, it is immune to both effects. The monster may spend a major action on its next turn to increase the swarm's roll penalty by -1.

The swarm typically lasts until the end of a scene, but area attacks and some monster abilities can end it early.

You can add enhancements to this attack the same as any other, but you should think about whether it will actually be fun to, say, anchor everyone in a scene at once. Will it be fun a second or third time? Will your coplayers agree??

Chemical	All rolls by corpses, still obliterates.
Cryonic	Defense rolls with Brawn.
Electrical	All rolls by gadgets.
Kinetic	All non-combat rolls {perceive, etc.}
Necrotic	Defense rolls vs condition.
Physical	Attack rolls with Brains.
Psychic	Attack rolls with Brawn, hits immune.
Radiation	Attack rolls to cause condition.
Thermal	Defense rolls with Brains.
Toxic	Deals extra stress instead. Starts at 2.

More details in the damage types section in Combat!

[TRANSFUSE]

As a major action, this monster may mark stress on this part in order to allow an ally within reach to clear that much stress.

A gadget with [TRANSFUSE] clears 1 less stress than it marks, due to spending a charge.

EXAMPLE: [TRANSFUSE][COMPOUND 1][CURE 1]

The monster can share some of its blood with allies to heal, and the phagocytes in its immune system will also cure the recipient.

[VANISH]

When you add this block to an ability, describe a single method of concealment, such as iridophoric camouflage or psigital invisibility. This monster can use a minor action to hide itself by employing the method described. The concealment lasts until it is damaged, revealed in some way, or uses a major action, whichever comes first.

While concealed, this monster can't be perceived—and can't, therefore, be directly targeted in most cases—by other creatures or objects unless they possess some form of appropriate enhanced or advanced sense that reasonably counters the method of concealment described, such as through the [PERCEIVE] block.

Passive Blocks

[ADAPT]

This monster gains one environmental adaptation per point spent on this block. Such adaptations include any trait that would help the monster to survive in a hostile or specialized environment, and which aren't already covered by another block. Examples are water breathing, high-altitude acclimation, resistance to the crushing pressures of deep water, or acclimation to severe temperatures.

Used as a weakness, specify an environment that your monster does poorly in, and then the condition or conditions it is afflicted with for the duration of its time in that environment.

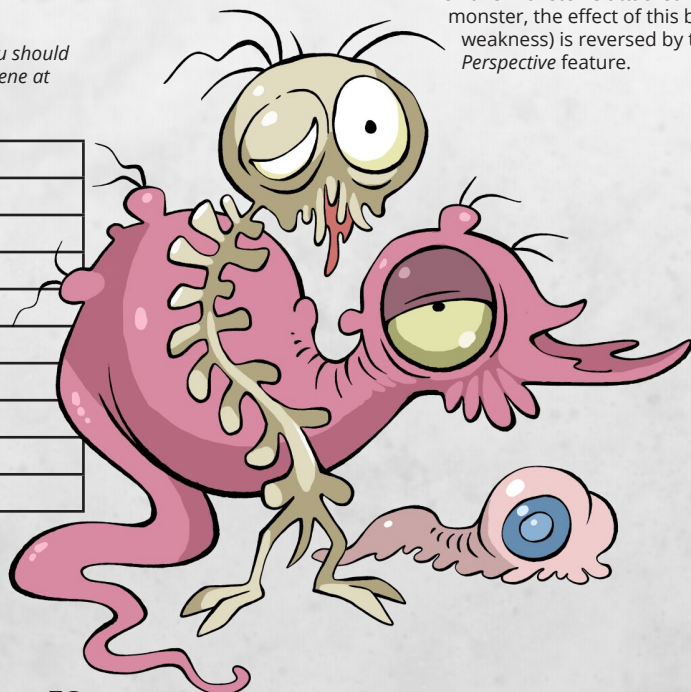
[ARMOR]

When you create this ability, choose Brains, Brawn, or anything you could specify for the [RESIST] block. When defending with the chosen attribute or against the chosen effect, this monster adds a bonus to its final result equal to the points spent on this block. For example, a monster with [ARMOR +2 brains] would add +2 to its final result when defending with Brains.

You can't use [COMBINE] to have armor for both attributes on one part.

[ARMOR] may be used as a straightforward -weakness, decreasing the defense total when receiving stress of the relevant type, or it may be used as a =>weakness, increasing the target's defense against the relevant type when this monster is attacking. For a =>weakness, the monster must be capable of using the relevant type of attack.

When this monster is attacked by a Warped monster, the effect of this block (or weakness) is reversed by the Outside Perspective feature.



[CORRAL]

Choose a type of organism, such as a monster class- when interacting with that kind of organism in a non-hostile fashion, you roll additional dice equal to the points invested in this block.

[CULL]

Choose a type of organism, such as a monster class- when interacting with that kind of organism in a hostile fashion, you roll additional dice equal to the points invested in this block.

[EMPTY]

This monster cannot be drained. Characters that try to drain it do not clear stress. When this monster is attacked by a Warped monster, the effect of this block is nullified by the Outside Perspective feature.

As for how you can break this ability and suddenly be vulnerable to drain attacks, imagine the part you put this ability on is the part you've sequestered all your valuable living fluids and organs in; breaking it causes them to spill out.

[ENCORE]

For each point spent on this block, the monster may use its core feature one additional time per whatever increment its core feature is measured in (so, for example, a Wormbrain may use its core feature another time each turn, or a Bioconstruct may use its quirk another time per adventure). Any enhancements applied to this ability apply to the core feature.

You may add this block to a monster with a core feature that wouldn't be affected by this block alone in order to adjust the function of that core feature with enhancements.

Example: The legendary Joker Harlequeen uses [ENCORE 9] to be able to swap up to 10 extra dice per turn using its core feature, like an absolute menace.

Meanwhile, the Fectoid Scrabies uses [AGGREGATE][SWARM physical][COM-POUND 1][ENCORE] to use its core feature against any monster within a swarm it summons.

Not every core feature can sensibly be used with [ENCORE], and this isn't an oversight. Don't go wracking your brains over how to use [ENCORE] alone with a feature that doesn't fit!

[ENGAGE]

When you create this ability, describe a relatively narrow category of tasks, such as "breaking barriers," "running and jumping," "board games," "dancing," or "giving hugs." Whenever this monster attempts a task that falls reasonably within the category described, it adds dice to its pool equal to the points spent on this block.

You may take a positive value [ENGAGE] block as a weakness if the bonus is strictly worse for your scientist, such as [ENGAGE harming allies]. There might be some cases where the Outside Perspective feature can reverse this effect. Remember that the feature functions when the Warped is attacking, not defending.

[IMPRESS]

Choose a target audience for your monster, like a specific class of scientists. When this monster is alive and on the scene, NPCs that fit the relevant criteria treat your Reputation as 1 higher per point invested in [IMPRESS].

[LURE]

When this monster is on the field, it is the only monster that takes damage and penalty from swarms. Multiple monsters with lure will all take damage for no additional benefit. If it's a Warped's swarm, it only *ignores* the [LURE].

[MOVE]

This monster gains a speed 1/2 movement of your choice from the following: Burrowing, climbing, hovering, leaping, swimming, or land.

For the purposes of enhancement blocks you might add, the target of [MOVE] is the place you're moving to.

You learn each type of movement as if it were a different block.
See [DAMAGE] for more details.

[MUFFLE]

For each point invested in this block, you may specify one sense that cannot perceive this monster. The effect is broken until next turn if the monster does something especially flashy related to the sense it is hidden from, such as emitting a bright light or making a loud sound.

You can also use [MUFFLE] as a weakness to indicate that it is very easy to spot with a certain sense. For example, [MUFFLE =>3d10 thermal] would mean an adversary rolls three extra dice to find this monster using thermal imaging or heat sensing.

When this monster is "attacked" by a Warped monster with the Outside Perspective feature, the effect of this block is ignored if it is an ability, and reversed if it is a weakness.

[PERCEIVE]

When you create this ability, describe a single enhanced or advanced sense to function within range plus one. Examples are night vision, heightened smell, electroreception, or echolocation. This monster uses a dice pool equal to two plus the points spent on this block whenever it attempts a task that is reasonably related to the sense described.

As a major action, it may also use this sense as a vehicle for any linked enhancement blocks, affecting targets within range as appropriate. For instance, this might mean that using its x-ray vision emits enough radiation to debilitate its target via [APPEND]. This monster can still choose to look at things without using any attached enhancements.

[PROTECT]

Whenever creatures or objects within range would be affected by an incoming effect, this monster may use a reaction to suffer the effect in place of a number of targets up to the points spent on this block—marking all stress, gaining all conditions, and so on.

For clarity, the monster takes the effect as the original target would, and does not apply its own bonuses or resistances. It doesn't have time to properly position itself to use all its abilities, and it would be a pain to reroll the dice, too.

[RAMPAGE]

You may activate or deactivate your monster's rampage as your scientist's major action. While the rampage is active, this monster always acts Amok, and adds +1 to all rolls per point invested in [RAMPAGE]. While it is inactive, this monster is always Anchored and Pacified.

Monsters may act normally in a scene that is calm enough but must be either rampaging or inactive if a scene is sufficiently stressful, such as a heated exchange or supper being fifteen minutes late.

When this monster is attacked by a Warped monster, the numerical bonus of this block when rampaging is reversed by the Outside Perspective feature.

[RECOVER]

When you create this ability, specify a number of conditions or non-instantaneous effects equal to the points spent on this block. The duration of all specified conditions and effects is reduced by one step for this monster: From "until removed" to "until the end of the current scene," or from "until the end of the current scene" to "until the end of this monster's next turn."

[REGENERATE]

This monster clears stress equal to the points spent on this block at the end of its turn, and clears all stress at the end of every scene. Stress cleared in this way can be divided however you wish among this monster's body parts. A dead monster doesn't clear stress with this ability (although a monster that somehow returns to life at the end of a scene is no longer "dead," and would therefore benefit normally from this block).

A gadget with regenerate can't clear stress from the same part that is granting it regeneration.

Remember, you can only unbreak one part per action or effect. That includes clearing stress at the end of a scene with [REGENERATE]

[RESIST]

When you create this ability, choose a single damage type or condition. When defending against the chosen damage type or condition, this monster adds dice to its pool equal to the points spent on this block.

Alternatively, you may choose a more abstract concept or circumstance (e.g. "low confidence" or "metal objects"), so long as your choice is no broader than a damage type would be.

You may take a positive value [RESIST] block as a weakness if the bonus is strictly worse for your scientist, such as [RESIST +1d10 scientist commands]. When this monster is attacked by a Warped monster, the effect of this block (or weakness) is reversed by the Outside Perspective feature.

Enhancement Blocks

[ABSORB]

When you add this block to an ability, this monster clears an amount of stress equal to the points invested in this block whenever it is subject to an effect that matches the descriptor of the active or passive block this is attached to. Stress is cleared regardless of whether the monster suffers the listed effect, and [ABSORB] does not prevent the effect from taking place if the monster (for example) fails a defense roll. Stress cleared in this way can be divided however you wish among this monster's parts.

When used as a weakness, [ABSORB] indicates that when the monster is

affected by a specific type of attack, the attacker clears that much stress distributed however it pleases. When this monster is attacked by a Warped monster, the effect of this block (or weakness) is reversed by the Outside Perspective feature. If it is an ability, the target will mark extra stress, and if it is a weakness the attacker will mark stress instead of clearing it. Both are allocated as the injured monster chooses.

[AGGREGATE]

Add this block to an ability with the [SWARM] block, and as a major action, this monster can store power for its next swarm, allowing it to begin the swarm with 1 more point of penalty for each turn it spends aggregating beforehand. However, it loses the ability to unleash a swarm without aggregating first.

[APPEND]

When you add this block to an ability, choose a number of conditions equal to the points invested in this block. Whenever a character is affected by the linked ability, it also gains the chosen conditions until the end of its next turn. "Affected by" means the target suffers or clears stress from the ability, fails to defend against the ability, passively benefits from the ability, or otherwise appropriately interacts with the linked ability's effect in a manner which would reasonably cause the chosen condition.

In the case of eroding or ruptured, you may choose a damage type when you add this block.

You learn each condition descriptor as if it were a separate block, but learn the relevant [INFLICT] descriptor at the same time if you know [INFLICT].

See [DAMAGE] for more details.

[ARMAMENTIFY]

When this part breaks, it drops clean off the monster more or less intact and can be used as a gadget by any character who picks it up. The resulting gadget has the same ability this part does, and energy (endurance) equal to the points spent on [ARMAMENTIFY]. It does not suffer penalty from having been damaged as a monster's part.

If you [SHED] a part that also has [ARMAMENTIFY], the gadget is created when the spawn falls in battle.

[AWAKEN]

When added to an ability that clears stress, that ability may target a dead monster to clear 1 stress from its core and bring it back to life. The core counts as a part for the limit of "one part unbroken per effect."

[BLINK]

The monster moves so fast that characters cannot activate a [TRAMPLE], [RESPOND], or [COUNTER] ability in response to this ability. [BLINK] counters itself, and so an ability with [BLINK] can react to or during an ability with [BLINK].

If a character is slowed by some effect, they cannot [BLINK].

Example: [RESPOND ally is targeted by a blink attack][BLINK][INFLICT +1d10 inhibited/brains]

This monster is specifically built to counter blinking monsters, using its own blink block to respond to a blink attack by slowing them, preventing any further blinking.

This also means YOU cannot activate a reaction or counter if you're somehow caught while blinking! As for trample, well, were those four nanoseconds of contact really enough to shock something?

A monster moving this fast can't typically be seen while moving, so it may appear to have vanished if it ends its action hidden. Most monsters can't tell what they're looking at when THEY'RE blinking, either!

[CAST]

The linked ability can, optionally, be sourced from a kind of entity that you specify across any distance within reason and within sensory range. You may specify one fairly specific kind of thing that you can use the ability from, such as a type of monster or a type of terrain, per point spent on this block.

You can never cast from the target of the ability.

Examples: Some solid examples include [CAST] blocks that can cast from their spawns, their creations, dead monsters, or a specific other monster species.

[CHANGE]

Whenever a target is affected by the linked ability, this monster may alter any number of descriptors (damage types, areas of effect, conditions, or anything else you must choose when selecting a block other than the attribute it attacks with, its point distribution, or blocks used to create another block) for a single ability possessed by the target whose point cost doesn't exceed the points spent on this block. "Affected by" means the target suffers or clears stress from the ability, fails to defend against the ability, passively benefits

from the ability, or otherwise appropriately interacts with the linked ability's effect. The changes last until the end of the current scene, unless another effect reverts them earlier.

[CLEAVE]

When you add this block to an ability, choose either burst or line. The linked ability becomes an area effect of the chosen type. You may spend 2 points on this block to purchase both burst and line, changing the linked ability to a cone, instead.

(Bursts affect everything engaged with or close by their target. Lines affect everything between their origin and endpoint. Cones affect everything from their origin to end-point, and everything engaged with one of those characters except you. Remember that a character in another zone is never close by or engaged. A burst attack also includes the user in its list of valid targets!)

[CLING]

Whenever this monster successfully affects one or more targets with the linked ability, it may grapple a number of those targets within range up to the number of points invested in this block, which is also the maximum number of targets that may be simultaneously grappled at any time via the linked ability. Any actions performed by a grappled target which don't affect this monster have their degree of success reduced by one step (crit to success, success to failure, or failure to botch).

A grappled creature or object can't move away from this monster. If a grappled target is smaller than this monster (and not securely attached to something), it moves along with this monster for as long as it remains grappled (barring commonsense exceptions, such as an unusually heavy or dense target). If a grappled target is larger than this monster, this monster sticks to the target and moves as it moves. The grapple can be broken with a successful opposed roll, made by an affected target as a major action.

[COMBINE]

Placing this block on an ability allows you choose multiple descriptors for a block that normally only allows one, such as [MOVE] or [PERCEIVE]. You may place one extra descriptor on this ability per point invested in [COMBINE]. This block may also be used to allow a gadget or module's ability to affect both the gadget or lair and its user at once.

Example: [MOVE land, burrow, swim][COMBINE 2][DASH +1]

The monster's muscular, wormy trunk can slither across the ground, through the water or burrow through the earth at a medium speed with equal ease- but breaking it will remove all three movement types.

[COMMAND]

When attached to an ability that deals psychic damage or uses [EXPRESS], [COMMAND] allows you to specify a variety of conditions that the ability *could* cause. For each point of [COMMAND], you may specify a condition or something to forbid (as the [FORBID] block), and when the ability is used, you may choose to *append* any combination of these conditions or none of them.

[COMPOUND]

When you add this block to an ability, choose an active or passive block that could reasonably function as an enhancement block and as a component of this ability. You may add the chosen block to this ability; its point cost is separate from this block. For example, you might spend 1 point to add [COMPOUND 1], allowing you to spend a further 1 point to attach [FORBID] to an ability, resulting in targets of the ability becoming unable to undertake a specified activity until the end of the scene when they are affected by the ability.

- You may invest extra points into this block to purchase subsequent active or passive blocks as enhancement blocks. Purchased enhancements function as [APPEND]ed if applicable.
- You still can't add more than 1 of the same active or passive block to this body part.
- You may invest extra points in a block as normal if appropriate, such as investing extra points to [REPAIR] more stress, without increasing the amount of points you must invest in [COMPOUND].

Active blocks you would normally invest a number of points into to enhance dice pools cannot be enhanced in this way, because they do not roll any dice in this context, and instead automatically succeed if the part of the ability you rolled dice for did.

- Generally, all effects of one ability affect the same target, unless a block specifically says otherwise, like [DRAIN], but your proctor might allow stranger and more complex effects if you discuss it with them.

Something important to note when building a complex ability with [COMPOUND] is that you're going to have to choose which ability is "up first." That's because this is the actual action you're taking, the one that's important to look at when judging if you're prevented from using this ability by effects such as the anchored condition or the above-mentioned [FORBID] block. Nothing else on the ability will even happen if the first block fails to take, because the others are all enhancements now!

The easiest way to keep track of this, of course, is just to make sure to write the first block on the front of the ability line, since it otherwise doesn't matter what order you put blocks in! For extra active blocks you could also only add the dice notations to the one that actually rolls any dice.

Example: [ENGULF +1d10][COMPOUND 2][REPAIR 4][CURE 1]
The CC14-Lazaroid rolls three dice to engulf a character, but instead of digesting them, it rapidly heals them while they're inside.

In order to create this ability, whoever invented the Lazaroid invested 2 points in [COMPOUND] in order to be able to add both the [CURE] and [REPAIR] blocks (normally active blocks) to the [ENGULF] ability (also an active block.) It still cost 2 more points to actually add [CURE] and [REPAIR], and then to increase the speed of healing, the creator chose to spend 3 more points on the [REPAIR] block. The whole thing costs as much as a single starter Demishade, but it's undeniably very powerful and versatile!

[CONCOCT]

When added to an ability that deals toxic or chemical stress, this acts as a wildcard enhancement. As a major action you may reconfigure the [CONCOCT] block to any combination of enhancements that add up to the amount of points spent on this block. You still have to know the enhancement blocks you wish to use.

[COUNTER]

The linked ability becomes a reaction for this monster, instead of a minor or major action.

[DASH]

When you add this block to a movement speed, the number of zone borders it can cross in one minor action with that move is increased by +1. Usually a total speed of +6 allows you to cross an entire battlefield in one move, but +2 is often more than enough speed.

[DETONATE]

The linked ability ceases to function as a repeatable action, and instead becomes a single-use action. The base action required to use the ability (minor, major, or reaction) doesn't change. When this monster uses the linked ability, it doubles its bonus or the number of dice in its pool (as appropriate to the ability), and this body part is obliterated (breaks and cannot be repaired in most circumstances.) Additionally, all conditions caused by a detonation last until cured.

No, you can't ever make an opponent [DETONATE] itself by granting it that ability somehow. [HIJACK] obliterates your part, you can't put [DETONATE] on [BOLSTER], and if a monster used an ability you shared it'll obliterate the part you shared it from. Whatever other clever idea you came up with won't work either; it wouldn't be fun, promise. Just use a grenade.

[DISCLUDE]

When added to an ability with an area effect, [DISCLUDE] allows a monster to disclude one target from the effect per point invested in this block.

[DISCRIMINATE]

Change the effect of an ability to be completely different against a certain type or types of target, like "a Wormbrain or its victims" or "a target that is on fire." Your target can be as specific as you want, but must be more specific than "hostile" or "non-hostile." Specify the effect of the ability using the same amount of points on the original ability, and this effect will occur only, and always, when the target meets the relevant condition, automatically. You can

add another point of [DISCRIMINATE] to specify another different effect, but it can't be something that could overlap with previous target conditions. The sub-abilities created by [DISCRIMINATE] must be able to reach the target that activates the effect, or they won't work. For instance, if you want to hit each character in a line with an attack that changes based on what kind of monster it hits, the base ability and [DISCRIMINATE]'s version of the ability must BOTH have [CLEAVE line] and the same [REACH].

If all the [DISCRIMINATE] does is add one extra block, you can easily notate it as something like "[DISCRIMINATE target is a vampire (APPEND nauseated)]" instead of listing the entire ability again with one extra block.

Simple Example: [DAMAGE +2d10 electrical/brawn]

[DISCRIMINATE target is heavily metallic (DAMAGE +1d10 electrical/brawn, REACH +1, CLEAVE burst)]

This monster fires a lightning bolt, which can reach more and further targets if the main target is conductive.

Advanced Example: [DAMAGE +1 thermal/brawn]

[PIERCE][PENETRATE] [DISCRIMINATE target generates electricity and is not xenogog (DRAIN)][DISCRIMINATE target is xenogog (DAMAGE +1d10 cryonic/brawn, APPEND corrupted, APPEND fettered, APPEND numb, PIERCE, SUSTAIN)]

Xenogog's Ghost Spike deals thermal damage to any part of a target it wants without rolling dice, and if its target generates electricity it can heal by absorbing power. But if its target is another Xenogog, it will cause icy nerve damage that locks down its opponent long-term.

[DRAIN]

Whenever this monster succeeds on an offense roll with the linked ability, it clears stress up to one-half the difference between the result and the failed defense roll (rounded up). For example, if the ability succeeds with a result of 12 versus a defense result of 6, the user could clear up to 3 stress (because $12 - 6 = 6/2 = 3$). Stress cleared in this way can be divided however you wish among this monster's body parts.

Remember, you can only unbreak one part per action or effect!

[EMANATE]

The linked ability ceases to be an action, if it is one, and instead becomes an effect which constantly radiates from this monster. All viable targets other than this monster close by are affected by the linked ability immediately when they become close by. Thereafter, targets are affected by this ability at the beginning of their turns for as long as they are close by. If the ability is an active ability, the effect occurs as if the monsters were targeted by the active effect; if the effect is a passive ability, monsters have this ability for the duration of their stay in the emanation. For the purpose of this ability, [PERCEIVE] is an active block. Uniquely, you cannot put [EMANATE] and [REACH] on the same ability in the expected fashion.

[ENDURE]

When you add this block to an ability, this body part gains bonus endurance boxes equal to the number of points spent on this block.

[EXPAND]

When added to an ability with the [CLEAVE burst] block, it hits every target in the same zone as the target that does not have a barrier or another zone between it and the original target. If added to an ability with the [EMANATE] block, the emanation hits every target in the same zone that does not have another zone between it and the originator of the effect.

[FESTER]

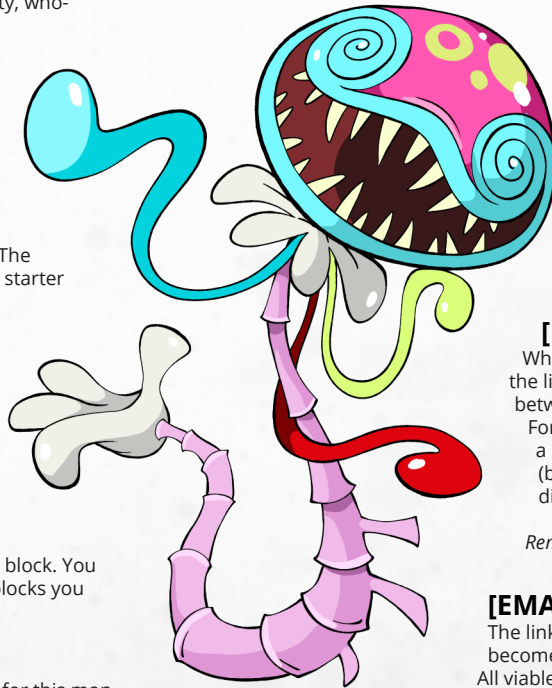
When linked to a passive ability, this block allows the ability to continue functioning even while the monster is dead. As long as the monster is dead, this ability functions even if the part is broken.

As a weakness you may designate an ability with [FESTER] to only function if the monster is actually dead. Treat this as [FESTER -1] and add one point of weakness for each accordingly.

Example: [FESTER -1 alpha decay], using the name of the ability as a descriptor.

[FLATTEN]

The linked ability smooths out or otherwise clears difficult terrain where sensible, allowing all characters to traverse it at full speed.



[HIJACK]

When you add this block to an ability, this monster can no longer use it normally. Instead, if this monster invades another monster, it can use a major action to force its host to use this ability. This doesn't use up the host's actions, and happens on your turn.

[IGNORE]

Whenever this monster would be affected by the damage type or condition specified by the linked ability, it may choose to instead suffer no stress or not gain the condition. This is not an action at all, but may only occur once per round per ability. When this monster is attacked by a Warped monster, the effect of this block is bypassed by the Outside Perspective feature.

So for example, if a monster has [RESIST toxic][IGNORE] and [RESIST chemical][IGNORE], it can ignore one instance each of toxic and chemical stress per round. If it has one ability with [RESIST chemical, toxic][COMBINE 1][IGNORE], it can ignore one instance of toxic OR chemical stress per round.

[INSULATE]

This monster doesn't mark stress against this body part until its core is exposed, nor can this part be targeted until then. The effect of [INSULATE] supercedes the effect of [SHIELD].

Your monster may have up to two insulated parts only if it has five or more total parts. Otherwise, it may have one. When attacked by a Warped monster, this block instead acts as if it were the [SHIELD] block.

[LINK]

Choose a part other than the core or the part this is on. You may spend 2 extra points on this ability, specified when creating or editing that ability, which are lost when the specified part breaks.

In a lot of cases, this block isn't necessary just because two parts should logically be connected- if you lose your legs but your ankle-blades are still intact, pick those suckers up and get stabbing!

For each point spent on [LINK], the number of points of weakness you may add to your monster is decreased by 1, as are any requirements related to minimum weakness points.

Example: [LINK neck (DAMAGE +2d10 physical/brawn+1)][APPEND 2 corrupted, rotten]

Sourtrout has a tough set of rotting jaws, but loses the ability to use them if it chooses to use its head as a bomb instead,

[PENETRATE]

When you add this block to an ability, that ability ignores defensive effects that control, dictate, or restrict targeting or the distribution of stress from an attack or effect, such as the [INSULATE], or [SHIELD] blocks. A monster's core must still be exposed before the core can suffer stress.

A lair module with [PENETRATE] can target scientists inside their lair- as long as something can see them.

[PHASE]

When added to an ability, [PHASE] allows the ability to affect opponents through walls or other targets. If placed on a movement ability, your monster gains the ability to move through walls when using that ability. Phase movement also ignores trample and phase attacks do not count as making contact with a target. This does not give your monster the ability to see through walls, and does not allow you to bypass [SHIELD] or [INSULATE].

[PIERCE]

When you add this block to an ability, any target defending against that ability reduces their final defense result by a number equal to the amount of points invested in this block, to a minimum of zero.

[PREPARE]

When added to an ability with the [TRANSFER] or [CONCOCT] quality, that ability may start with pre-determined conditions. You may apply as many points of ability as you invest points in this block, even if that is more points than spent on the relevant block. In that case, you simply start out with more or stronger conditions than you can acquire during a scene.

[REACH]

When you add this block to an ability, that ability's range increases by +1 for each point spent on this block.

An ability with [REACH] always reaches that many zone borders past range zero, except if the monster is miniscule, in which case it reaches that many zones minus one. Usually a total of 6 range lets you hit across any relevant distance. As a weakness, you may add [REACH -1] to an ability to decrease its range below the usual for its size, notated in the monster's weaknesses as [REACH -1 name of ability].

[RECOIL]

This is a special block that counts as adding a point of weakness, and thus costs -1 point to add to an ability, but when you add together your points of weakness and points from [RECOIL] (or [LINK]), it must not exceed your monster's allowed weakness. The bonus point from this block must be spent on the same ability it is linked to. Choose an effect from the following list:

- This monster marks 2 stress on this body part, all of which must be in the same endurance box if possible.
- This monster gains a specific condition, chosen when you create this ability, until the end of the current scene.
- This monster becomes unable to undertake a specified activity as per the [FORBID] block, chosen when this ability is created, until the end of the current scene.

Each time this monster uses the linked ability (or the linked ability activates, etc.), it suffers the chosen effect. If it can't suffer the chosen effect, it can't use the linked ability. For instance, if 2 stress can't be marked on this part, or if this monster already has the specified condition (and it doesn't stack), the linked ability would be unusable. If the monster can ignore the condition from othersources, it cannot do so from this ability.

You may add this block to an ability more than once; each time, you may subtract another point from the ability's cost, but this monster cumulatively suffers all chosen effects for each instance of this block in the linked ability. For example, an ability might use 2 instances of [RECOIL] to reduce its cost by 2, but using it means marking 2 full endurance boxes on the associated body part (or being unable to use the ability, if you can't), or inflicts both numb and haywire, and so on.

[RESPOND]

The linked ability ceases to be an action, and instead becomes a conditional effect that occurs automatically when its triggering condition is met. You specify the triggering condition when you add this block; triggering conditions can be nearly anything, as long as it is something that happens, and not something this monster does, such as "this monster suffers stress," "a gadget is dropped," "an allied monster dies," and so on.

The linked ability takes effect immediately after the triggering condition is met, requiring no action from this monster, and immediately before resolving any effects that prevent the linked ability from activating (such as the death of *this* monster). If the linked ability requires a target, the target is always the creature or object that met or caused the triggering condition, as appropriate. For example, if a monster responds to an ally receiving a condition, it may immediately attack the foe that caused it, or cure the ally that received it. If that target is not viable (for instance, if it isn't within range of the linked ability), the linked ability doesn't trigger, but otherwise the monster cannot choose not to use its response.

You may take [RESPOND] as a weakness and build an ability for it if the combined effect is strictly worse for your think tank, such as [RESPOND this monster receives healing][DAMAGE +1d10 physical] which would cause the monster to lash out at allies that attempt to heal it in some way. If you do, the final point value of the ability is instead treated as points of weakness in all ways.

[SAMPLE]

Whenever this monster succeeds on an offense roll with the linked ability, it grants you data and scanalysis progress (if appropriate) up to one-half the difference between the result and the failed defense roll (rounded up).

[SHAMBLE]

When added to an active ability, the ability may be used while the monster is dead, a number of times up to the number of points invested in this block. Like the abilities on a dead Zomboid, these still suffer applicable penalties.

*Example [SWARM chemical][APPEND corrupted][INSULATE][SHAMBLE 1]
After Toxodont's death, its third lung will eventually relax one final time, expelling more caustic smog.*

[SHARE]

This monster can use a minor action to "give" the linked ability to another creature within range until the beginning of its next turn. While the linked ability is shared in this way, this monster can't use it, but the target creature can, and it functions in all ways identically. The linked ability isn't installed in the target's body parts while shared, although destruction of the body part in which the linked ability is installed on this monster causes the target to lose access to the ability, if it's sharing at the time. This monster can also end the sharing early as a minor action.

[SHED]

As a major action, you may immediately break this part to create a spawn with the same ability and endurance as this part. The spawn uses the same stats as the original monster. If this character is grappled when it sheds its part, it immediately escapes the grapple with no roll.

If both the monster and its shed-spawn are alive, the monster can reattach this part with a major action when it is within range, which retains any stress it received as a spawn.

[SHED] Example: [SHED][EMANATE][CURE 1]

The monster emanates an aura that can cure its allies of status conditions, and can choose to sacrifice some of its safety to leave the aura behind if it is needed elsewhere for other reasons.

[SHIELD]

This monster doesn't mark stress against other body parts until this part is broken, even if the attacker intends to target something else.

Your monster may have up to two shield parts only if it has five or more total parts. If it does, you may distribute incoming damage among the shielded parts normally. Otherwise, it may have one.

When attacked by a Warped monster, this part instead acts as if it were the [INSULATE] block.

[SHUNT]

Choose towards or away. When the linked ability successfully affects a target, it is moved in that direction an amount of zone borders equal to the points spent on [SHUNT]. If it impacts a wall or another monster that is too large to move or break, both mark 1 stress per remaining zone border it would have crossed had it not hit an obstacle.

[SPOUT]

When used immediately after an ability with [DRAIN] or [SAMPLE], this ability adds the value of gained endurance or data as a bonus to its roll.

You must choose whether to use [DRAIN] or [SPOUT] on an individual action, you can't do both.

Example: [DAMAGE +1d10 electrical/brawn][REACH +1][SPOUT]

The monster attacks with electricity, and can utilize the water from blood it has drained as a conductive medium.

[SQUEEZE]

The linked ability functions as if the monster were smaller than it is, except for reach. Treat the source as one size category smaller per point of [SQUEEZE] for this ability.

[SUSTAIN]

When you add this block to an ability, increase the duration of temporary effects on the linked ability by one step per point of [SUSTAIN], skipping one more automatic cure and further escalating for each point. Until end of turn becomes until end of scene, which becomes start of break, then start of downtime, which then becomes never unless cured.

This effect does not apply to conditions caused by [RECOIL]

[SUSTAIN +3] reaches a permanent duration until cured for an [INFLICT] block, and 4 points will do the same to any other.

[TEND]

When added to an ability that has an effect that applies to the user only (other than [RECOIL]), this monster may apply that effect to another monster in range instead.

[TRANSFER]

When the attached [DRAIN] or [SAMPLE] ability successfully affects a target, it also "steals" conditions, curing them and storing the conditions. The next successful attack you make that has the transfer block instead afflicts the target with all of the stolen conditions at once. These conditions last until the end of your next turn.

You may steal and store as many conditions as you have points invested in this block.

Example: [DAMAGE +1 physical/brains][SAMPLE][TRANSFER]

After taking a sample of the victim and cataloguing it as well as any living infections it is suffering from, the monster can pass extra samples it doesn't need on to the next target to debilitate it.

[TRANSPLANT]

Your monster's core is hidden in this part, so it isn't exposed until this part breaks, but is immediately exposed if it does.

If the part with [TRANSPLANT] is shed (by the block of the same name, or by [ARMAMENTIFY]), the resulting spawn keeps the core and the monster only dies if the shed limb is killed. Enemies will not automatically know the core is in this part, but appearance or behaviour may give it away.

If the shed core dies or leaves the scene, the remainder of the monster is lobotomized, frenzied and amok and then dies at the end of the scene.

If a monster uses [TRANSPLANT] as well as [SHED] on the same ability, you may designate abilities that do not function when the core is shed. Treat this as [TRANSPLANT -1] and add one point of weakness for each accordingly. If every part is nonfunctional when the core is shed, the body does not gain frenzied or amok.

Like [TRANSPLANT -1 fireballch] or something, using the name of the ability as a descriptor.

[TRAMPLE]

The linked ability ceases to be an action, and instead becomes an effect which occurs automatically the first time each turn that this monster moves past another monster or a monster moves past it.

[UPSCALE]

The linked ability functions as if the monster were larger than it is, except for reach. Treat the source as one size category larger per point of [UPSCALE] for this ability.

Example: [ENGULF +1d10][UPSCALE 2][APPEND eroding:chemical]

This monster can unhinge its jaw to swallow a target even bigger than itself!

[WANDER]

Attached to a part that creates a spawn or swarm or other sub-entity, [WANDER] can be used to give movement to the creation. Each point of wandering gives the spawn or swarm one type of movement. For a shed part, speed starts at 1/2. For swarms, this increases the targets they can reach.

Alternatively, if you add this block to an ability with [ENGULF], you forgo choosing any movement types, and instead it allows the engulfed character to continue moving while engulfed, able to cross as many zone borders as you invest points in [WANDER], up to its original movement speed.

Example: [SHED][WANDER 2 hover, flight][DASH +1][DAMAGE +1d10 radiation/brawn][REACH +2]

The monster's part, which shoots radioactive beams, can detach and then hover or fly at a speed of 1.

